The CAD Pillar

ADMIN OPERATIONS MANUAL

The CAD Pillar | Admin Operations Manual

Run The CAD Pillar day to day. Every admin screen, control and procedure, with the checks and the fixes.

For
Administrators (Sales + Ops + Finance), and staff holding one of those roles

Edition
Edition 1 · 12 November 2026 · matches the platform as of release e14fc78

Publisher
Ichizu Private Limited · The CAD Pillar

Contents

Start here 4

How to use this manual 4

The platform in one page 4

Account types at a glance 5

Your first sign-in 6

What do you need to do? 12

Daily operations 14

Daily operating checklist 14

The Queue 14

All orders 16

The order page (team view) 17

Running an order from start to finish 19

Intake: where orders come from 19

Place an order for a client 19

Price an order (set a quote) 20

Record a transfer payment 22

Choose or change an order's pod 22

Confirm the order (start the clock) 23

Assign a designer (admin exception) 23

Move a job to another designer, or take it back 24

Resolve an escalation 25

Follow QC and the client's review 25

Deliver and close 26

Cancel an order or refund a client 27

Resolve a dispute 28

Decide a late first-look credit 28

Decide a spec claim 29

Write master instructions for a client 29

Issue a missing QC certificate 30

People: clients, designers, pod leads and staff 31

Exists versus can receive work 31

Designer applications 32

Add designers and get them working 32
Pod leads and pods 35
Staff accounts and roles (Access) 36
Clients 39
Website contact leads 41

Messages, files and visibility 42

Two conversations per order 42
Messages 42
Files on an order 44
Who sees what 44

Notifications and email 46

Check whether emails reach clients 48

Money 49

Prices, categories and pay 49
Billing 49
Pay designers and pod leads 51
Exports and reports 52

Settings, switches and audit history 53

Settings 53
Feature switches 54
Audit history: who did what 55

How the accounts work together 56

Reference 60

Permissions matrix 60
Status and handoff table 61
Troubleshooting by symptom 63
Screen-by-screen reference 66
Glossary 67

Start here

This manual is for whoever runs The CAD Pillar day to day. Read chapters 1–3 on your first day. After that, use the task index, the daily checklist and the troubleshooting table as lookups.

How to use this manual

- **Bold** words are the exact labels on screen: buttons, menu items, tabs, column headings.
- "Open **Queue** → click **Price it** → click **Set quote**" means: click each item in turn.
- Paths such as `/admin/access` are the page's web address after `thecadpillar.com`. You can type them, but the sidebar always gets you there too.
- Callouts:
  - **Before you commit** marks an action that changes records, reaches a client, or cannot be undone.
  - **Known limit** marks something the platform does not do yet, and the way round it.
- Names in examples (Northline Jewelers, DSG-0007, Rhino pod, "Asha") are fictional. Screenshots come from a throwaway test system filled with test orders (titles such as "E2E halo ring"), never from live data.

The platform in one page

The CAD Pillar sells jewelry CAD (3D models ready for casting) and renders to jewelry businesses. Three groups use one portal:

- **Clients** order, pay, review and download.
- **The team** prices, takes payment, confirms and delivers. The team is the admins, plus Sales, Ops and Finance staff.
- **Pods** do the work. A **pod lead** assigns each job to one of the pod's **designers** and checks the result (quality control, "QC") before the client sees it.

Work flows in one direction: **admin** → **pod lead** → **designer**, then back up through QC to the client.

Stage	What happens	Who acts
1. Brief	The client describes the piece in three short steps and sends it for a price	Client (or the team, for an order that came by email or WhatsApp)
2. Quote	The team sets the category (A–L) and the price	Sales or Admin
3. Payment	The client pays by card or UPI, or the team records a bank, Wise or PayPal transfer	Client, or Finance / Admin
4. Pod and confirmation	The order joins a pod; the team confirms the brief, which starts the first-look clock	Admin (pod lead may confirm)
5. Assignment	The pod lead gives the job to one designer	Pod lead (Admin only as an exception)
6. Design	The designer models it, uploads four files, passes their own check and sends it to QC	Designer
7. QC	The pod lead checks it, then passes it to the client or sends it back	Pod lead

Stage	What happens	Who acts
8. First look and changes	The client approves, or asks for changes (two rounds included within 14 days)	Client
9. Delivery and close	The team marks it delivered, then closed. Pay becomes owed	Ops or Admin
10. Payouts	The team pays designers and pod leads by bank transfer from an export	Finance or Admin

---

Account types at a glance

Every person signs in to the same portal at **thecadpillar.com/sign-in**. What they see depends on their **role** (the kind of account) and their **status** (whether the account may act). Navigation is not access control: the database checks every action again, so a person never gains an ability by finding a link.

Account type (as shown on Access)	Workspace label	Sidebar colour	Lands on after sign-in	Main job
Client	Client workspace	White	**Home** (`/home`)	Orders CAD designs and renders, pays, reviews, approves, downloads
Designer	Designer workspace	White	**Home** (`/home`)	Models the jobs their pod lead assigns, checks them, sends them to QC
Pod lead (stored as role `QC`)	Pod lead workspace	Black	**QC queue** (`/qc`)	Assigns jobs within their pod, runs quality control, places orders for clients
Ops, **Sales**, **Finance**	Admin workspace	Black	**Queue** (`/admin`)	Run the business; each has part of the admin powers
Admin = Ops + Sales + Finance together	Admin workspace	Black	**Queue** (`/admin`)	Everything

What makes someone an "Admin"

The product has no single "Admin" role. A person is a **full Admin** when their account holds all three staff roles: **Sales**, **Ops** and **Finance**. One of these is their *primary* role (chosen on the Access screen); the other two are *additional* roles. The Access screen shows additional roles as small "+ Sales" / "+ Finance" tags beside the role menu.

A staff member who holds only…	Can	Cannot
Sales	Set quotes; work **Applications** and **Leads**	Mark payments, assign, deliver, close, manage people or settings
Ops	Change roles and suspend accounts on **Access**; assign a designer as an exception; deliver and close orders; send a dispute back for rework; work **Applications** and **Leads**	Quote, record payments, refund, manage designers, pods or settings
Finance	Mark a transfer received; refund; release escrow; export and mark payouts paid	Quote, assign, deliver, manage people or settings
Sales + Ops + Finance (full Admin)	All of the above, plus **Designers**, **Pods**, **Clients**, **Settings**, **Credits**, account managers, pay rates, designer documents and bank details	—

> **Adding the second and third staff roles is not on any screen**
>
> The Access screen sets a person's *primary* role only. Giving an Ops member the additional Sales and Finance roles (to make them a full Admin) needs a database change by technical support. See Make someone a full Admin.

Account status

Status (Access screen pill)	Meaning	Can sign in	Can act
Active	Normal account	Yes	Yes
Pending	Account exists but is not yet active. Designers added by the team start here until they sign the designer agreement.	Yes	Only what their role allows before activation (a designer cannot be assigned work)
Suspended	Frozen by an Ops member or Admin. Nothing is deleted.	Yes, but their actions are refused	No

There is no "delete account". Orders, files, money records and the audit history all refer to the person, so the product suspends instead.

Two ideas used throughout

- **Pod.** A small team: one **pod lead** and the **designers** placed in it. A pod lead sees and assigns only their pod's designers and orders. An order joins a pod when it is paid or confirmed (automatically while only one pod has a lead; otherwise an Admin chooses).
- **Anonymity.** A client never sees who designed their piece; a designer never sees who the client is or what the client paid. To the client, every team member is **"Your team"**. This is enforced by the database, not by hiding buttons.

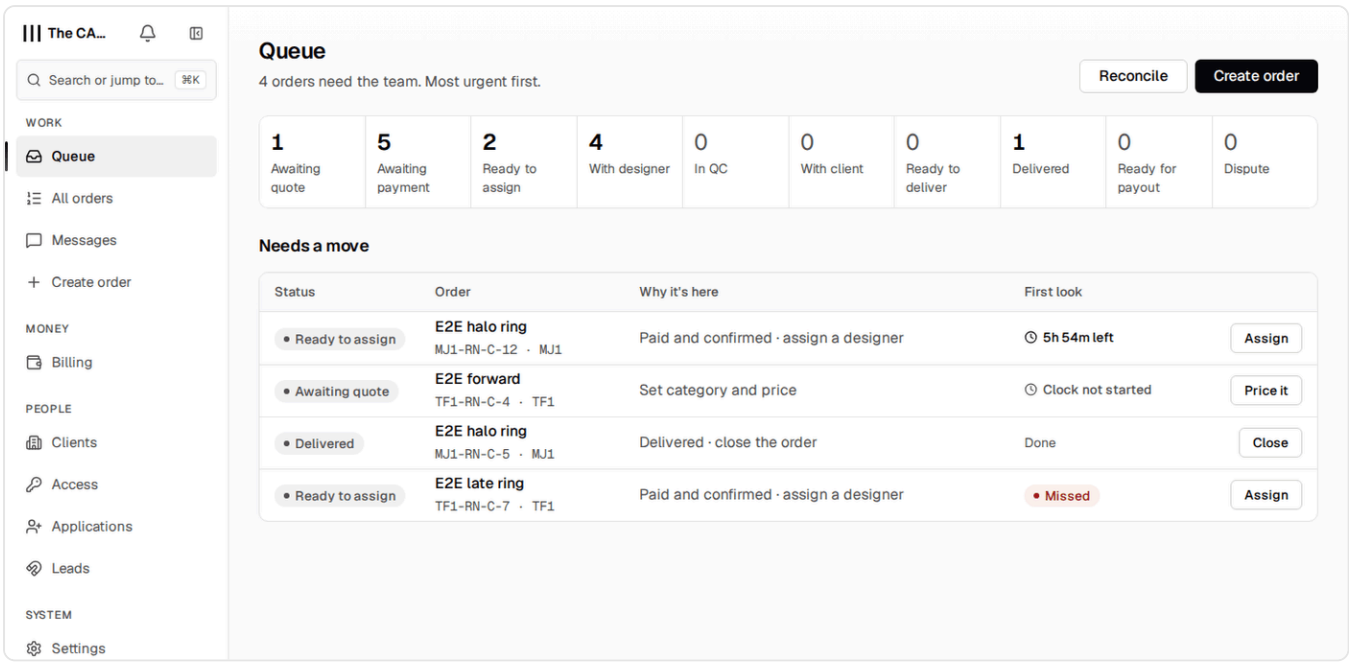
Your first sign-in

Signing in

1. Go to **thecadpillar.com/sign-in**.
2. Enter the email address your account was opened with.
3. Enter the code that arrives by email. No password is needed. If you set a password under **Account → Sign-in and security**, you can use it instead.
4. The portal opens on your role's starting page (see Account types at a glance).

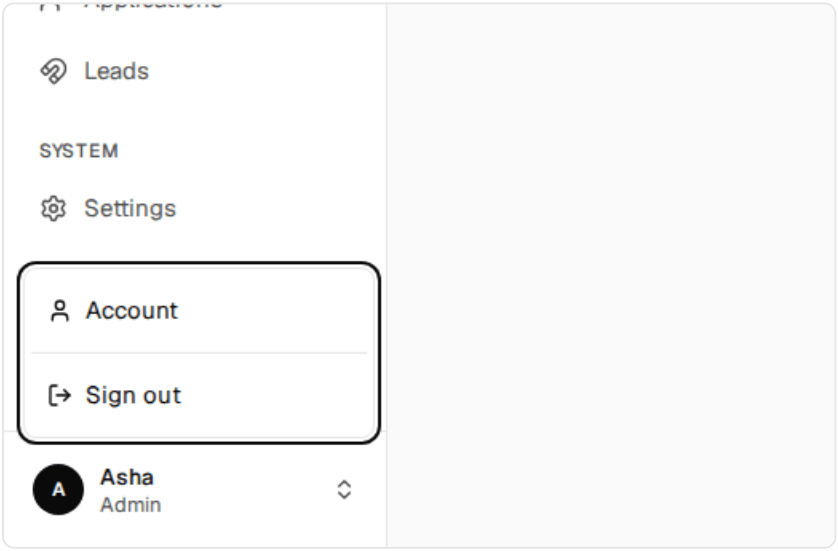
A new client who signs up without being invited is asked once, on **Welcome**, for their business details. Team members, designers and clients the team created skip that step.

Finding your way around

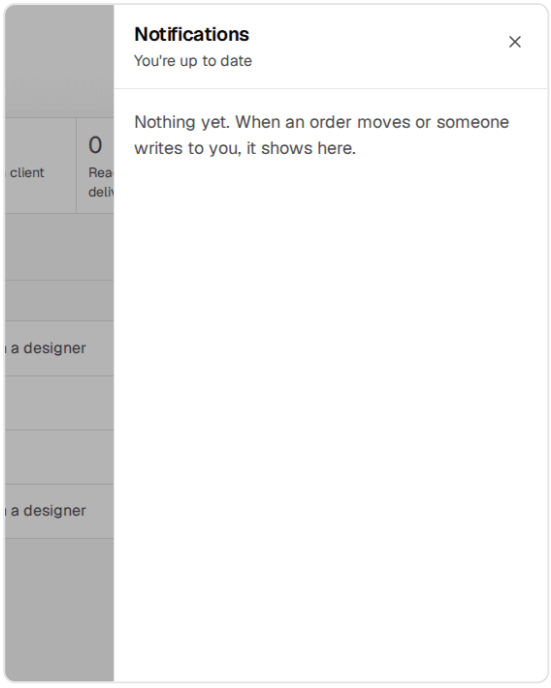


The Admin workspace on a computer: sidebar with groups, the bell and the search bar at the top, your name at the bottom

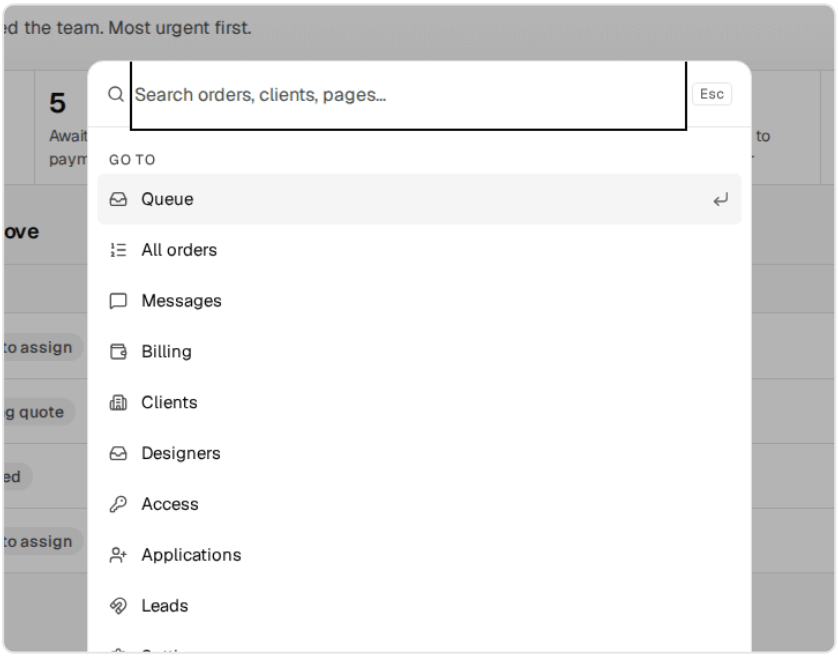
- **Sidebar (computer).** The workspace name and your destinations, grouped (for example **Work**, **Money**, **People**, **System**). The square icon beside the bell collapses the sidebar to icons and expands it again.
- **Bell.** Your notifications, newest first, with an unread count. Open it to read them; **Mark all read** clears the count. While the portal is open, anything new also pops up briefly with **Open**.
- **Search or jump to… ⌘K.** Press `Ctrl` + `K` (`⌘` + `K` on a Mac), or click the bar. Type an order reference (for example `MJ1-RN-C-4`), a client code or a page name. `Esc` closes it.
- **Your name (bottom of the sidebar).** Opens a small menu with **Account** and **Sign out**.
- **Unread counts.** The number beside **Messages** counts unread messages.



The menu under your name: Account and Sign out



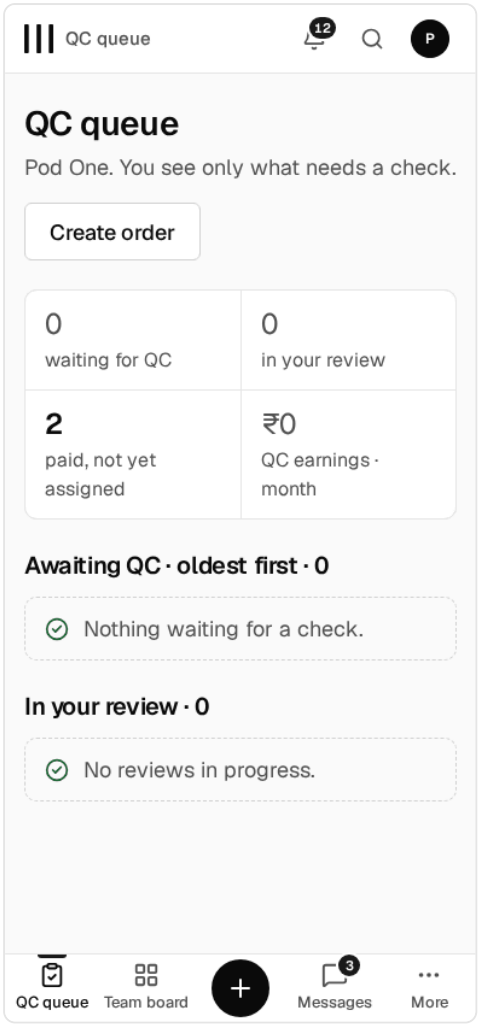
The notification panel opened from the bell



Search or jump: type a reference, a client code or a page

On a phone

The sidebar becomes a bar along the bottom of the screen. It shows your first two destinations, **Messages** (designers also get **Earnings**), and **More**. Roles that create orders also get a raised **+** button. **More** opens every other destination, plus **Sign out**. The top bar shows the page name, the bell and the search button.



A pod lead on a phone: the bottom bar with QC queue, Team board, the raised +, Messages and More

Your account page

Open your name → **Account** (on a phone: **More** → **Account**).

Section	Who sees it	What it is for
Your identity, roles	Everyone	Your name and email, and your role(s)
Client code	Clients	The code on all your orders (made from your business name)
Account reference	Everyone	Quote it when you contact the team or support
Your business	Clients	Business name, your name, work email, WhatsApp / phone, how you heard about us
Master instructions	Clients	Your factory's standing rules, shown on every order to the designer and pod lead (up to 4,000 characters; leave out company name and contact details)
Your logo	Clients	Shown on your 3D preview links (PNG or JPEG, up to 2 MB)
Sign-in and security	Everyone	Email, password, two-step sign-in, and the devices you are signed in on
Payout details	Designers	The bank account your earnings are paid into
Email	Clients	Which optional emails you get (order emails always arrive)

Section	Who sees it	What it is for
On this device	Everyone	**Time zone** (times on screen follow it; "This device" follows your computer or phone) and **Notifications** (push alerts on this device)
Sign out	Everyone	Ends the session on this device

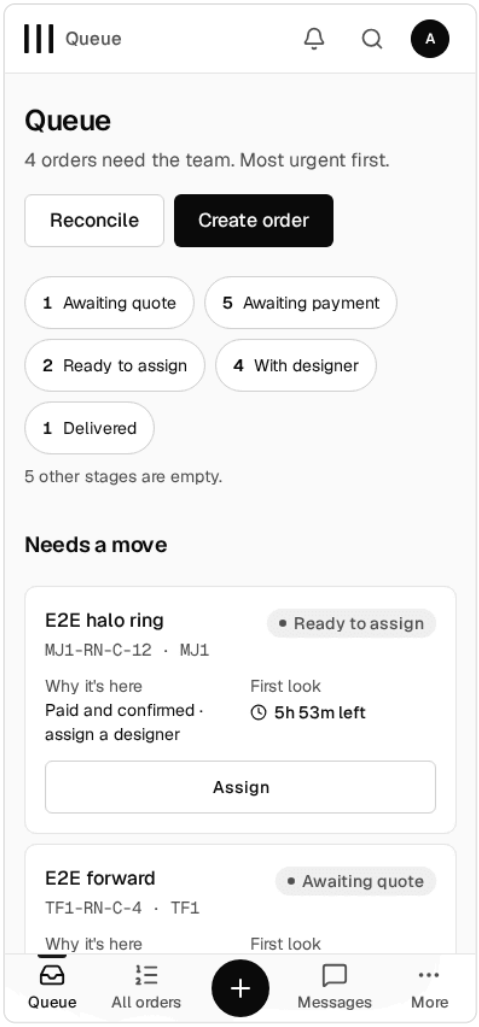
What you see the first time

As an admin you land on the **Queue**. The sidebar has these groups:

Group	Item	What it opens
Work	**Queue**	Orders that need a team move now, with stage counters (details)
Work	**All orders**	Every order, with tabs, search and **Export CSV** (details)
Work	**Messages**	Every order's client and designer conversations (details)
Work	**Create order**	Place an order for a client who wrote by email, WhatsApp or phone (details)
Money	**Billing**	Money in and out, late credits, the way to **Payouts** (details)
People	**Clients**	Every client by code, account managers, public numbers, where clients come from (details)
People	**Access**	Every account: role, status, suspend and reinstate (details)
People	**Applications**	Designer applications from the website (details)
People	**Leads**	Website contact-form messages (details)
System	**Settings**	The numbers the platform runs on, and feature switches (details)
More	**Designers**	Your designers: sign-in status, pod, pay rate, bank details, documents (details)

Four admin pages have no sidebar item. **Credits** opens from the Queue alert or **Billing**. **Payouts** opens from **Billing**. **Emails** opens from **Settings → Email previews**. **Pods** opens from **Access → Pods**.

On a phone the bottom bar shows **Queue**, **All orders**, **Messages** and **More**, with a raised **+** for **Create order**.



Admin on a phone: the Queue with the bottom bar

Before your first working day

1. Check your roles on **Account**. A full Admin shows Ops, Sales and Finance.
2. Open **Settings** → **Email previews** and note whether email is in **Test mode** or **Live**.
3. Open **Access** → **Pods** and check every pod has a lead and designers.
4. Open **Designers** and look for anyone **Waiting to sign in** or **Not in a pod**.

What do you need to do?

Find the task, then follow the link.

Every day

- Work through the daily checklist
- Read the Queue and its counters
- Find any order
- Answer client and designer messages

Orders

- Place an order for a client who emailed or used WhatsApp
- Price an order (set a quote)
- Record a bank, Wise or PayPal payment
- Choose or change an order's pod
- Confirm an order and start the clock
- Assign a designer yourself (exception)
- Move a job to another designer, or take it back
- Resolve a pod lead's escalation
- Follow QC and the client's review
- Deliver and close an order
- Cancel an order or refund a client
- Resolve a dispute ("Raise a problem")
- Decide a late first-look credit
- Decide a spec claim
- Write master instructions for a client
- Issue a QC certificate that is missing

People

- Understand "exists" versus "can receive work"
- Review a designer application
- Add designers and get them working
- Place a designer in a pod, or remove them
- Set a designer's own pay rate
- Record bank details and identity documents
- Make someone a pod lead and give them a pod
- Create a pod, change its lead, add or remove designers
- Change someone's role
- Make someone a full Admin
- Suspend or reinstate an account
- Name an account manager for a client
- Work the website contact leads

Money

- Read Billing
- Pay designers and pod leads (payout batches)
- Check pricing bands and pay rules

System

- Change a setting (clock, pay, densities)
- Turn a feature on or off
- Check whether emails reach clients
- Export data for a report
- Find out who did what (audit history)

References

- Permissions matrix
- Status and handoff table
- Troubleshooting by symptom
- Screen-by-screen reference
- Glossary

Daily operations

Daily operating checklist

Work top to bottom. Most days it takes 15–20 minutes. The live-support hours are 3 PM to midnight India time, so the busiest window is the US morning.

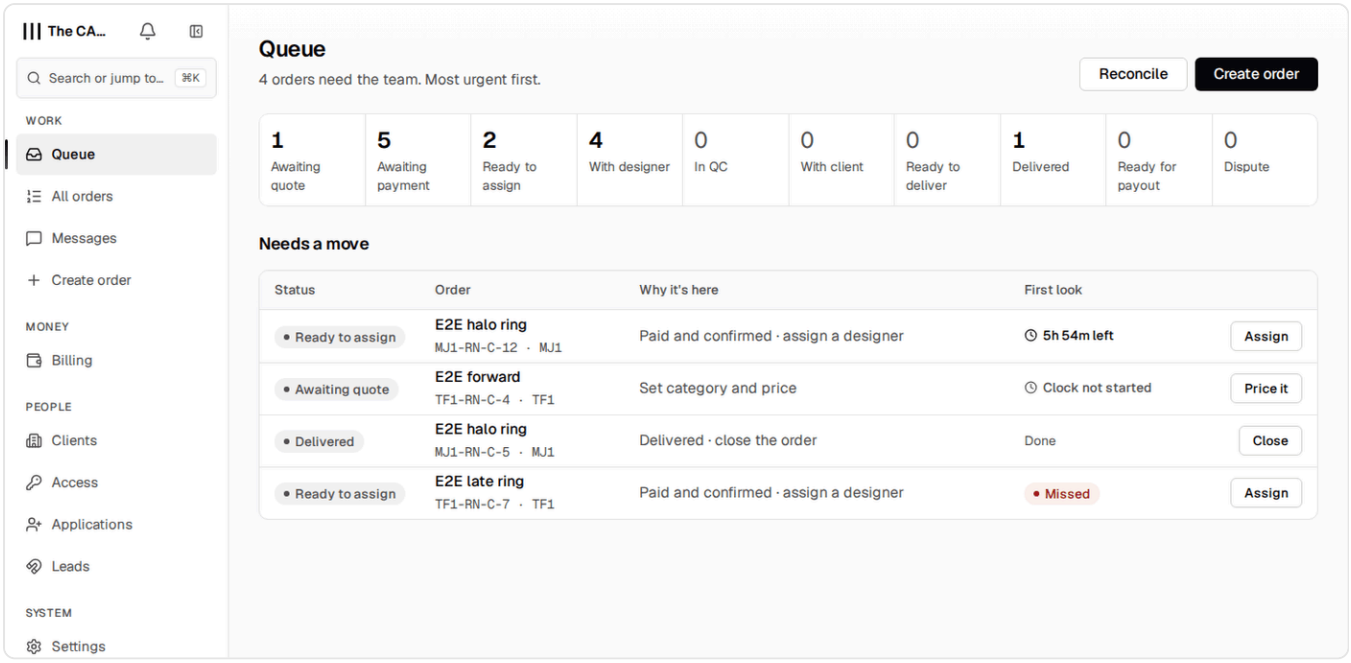
#	Where	Look for	Do
1	**Queue** → red and grey alerts above the list	"First look missed…", "…escalated by a pod lead", "…dispute open", spec claims	**Decide** / **Review** / **Show** each one (credits, escalations, disputes, claims)
2	**Queue** → **Awaiting quote**	New briefs (portal and team-placed)	Open each → **Set quote** (how)
3	**Queue** → **Awaiting payment**	Quotes not yet paid; transfers that arrived	**Mark paid** for transfers received (how); message slow payers
4	**Queue** → **Ready to assign**	Rows saying "Paid · choose a pod" or "Paid · confirm the order…"	**Choose** the pod, then **Confirm** (pod, confirm)
5	**Queue** → **Ready to assign**	Rows saying "Paid and confirmed · assign a designer" whose clock is running down	Check the pod lead is on it (**Team board** via the order's pod). Assign yourself only as an exception (how)
6	**Queue** → **With designer** and **In QC** counters	Jobs stuck for hours; the **First look** column turning red	Open the order; message the pod lead in the designer conversation
7	**Messages** → **Needs reply**	Clients waiting on the team, especially on orders with no pod yet	Reply in the **Client** tab (how)
8	**Queue** → **Ready to deliver** and **Delivered**	Approved orders not yet delivered; delivered orders not closed	**Deliver**, then **Close** (how)
9	**Applications** and **Leads**	New designer applications and contact messages	Accept / Reject; **Mark handled**
10	**Designers**	Anyone **Waiting to sign in**, **Not in a pod**, or with **No bank details**	Chase them; place them in a pod (how)

Weekly: export and pay the owed payouts (how); check **Billing** against the Razorpay dashboard; look at **Performance** per pod (opens from a pod lead's view, or from an escalation alert); check that **Settings** → **Email previews** still shows the mode you expect.

The Queue

Open: sidebar → **Queue** (`/admin`). This is your home page.

The Queue is a to-do list for the team. It lists only the orders where the team has the next move, ranked: disputes first, then the nearest first-look deadline, then the oldest.



The Queue: stage counters, then the orders that need a move

Top right.

- **Reconcile** opens **Billing**.
- **Create order** opens the form for an order placed on a client's behalf.

Stage counters. Each box counts the orders currently in that stage, team-wide. Click one to filter the list to that stage. Click it again, or click **Clear filter**, to go back.

Counter	Counts orders whose status is	Team move?
Awaiting quote	Submitted	Yes: price it
Awaiting payment	Quoted	No (the client pays), unless you record a transfer
Ready to assign	Paid	Yes: choose the pod, confirm, assign
With designer	Assigned, In progress, Revision requested	No: the designer's turn
In QC	Work submitted, In QC review	No: the pod lead's turn
With client	Ready to preview	No: the client's turn
Ready to deliver	Approved	Yes: deliver
Delivered	Delivered	Yes: close
Ready for payout	Closed	Yes: pay the team
Dispute	Disputed	Yes: resolve

The counters have no date range. They show the state right now.

Alerts (above the list, only when something needs a decision):

Alert	Button	Opens
"First look missed on N orders. Credits are waiting for your decision."	**Decide**	**Credits**
"N jobs escalated by a pod lead."	**Review**	**Performance** (escalation list)

Alert	Button	Opens
"N disputes open. The client is waiting on the team."	**Show**	The Queue filtered to **Dispute**
"Wall/Prong/… claim" with order, client and designer references	**Review**	The order's spec-claim panel

The list ("Needs a move").

Column	Shows
Status	The stage pill (black for **Dispute**)
Order	The job's title, the order reference (for example `TF1-RN-C-4`) and the client code
Why it's here	One sentence, for example "Paid and confirmed · assign a designer", "Set category and price", "Via WhatsApp · check the brief and price it"
First look	Time left on the clock; **Clock not started**; **Done** when the first look was on time; **Missed**
(action)	One button: **Price it**, **Choose** (pod), **Confirm**, **Assign**, **Deliver**, **Close**, **Release**, **Resolve**, or **Open**

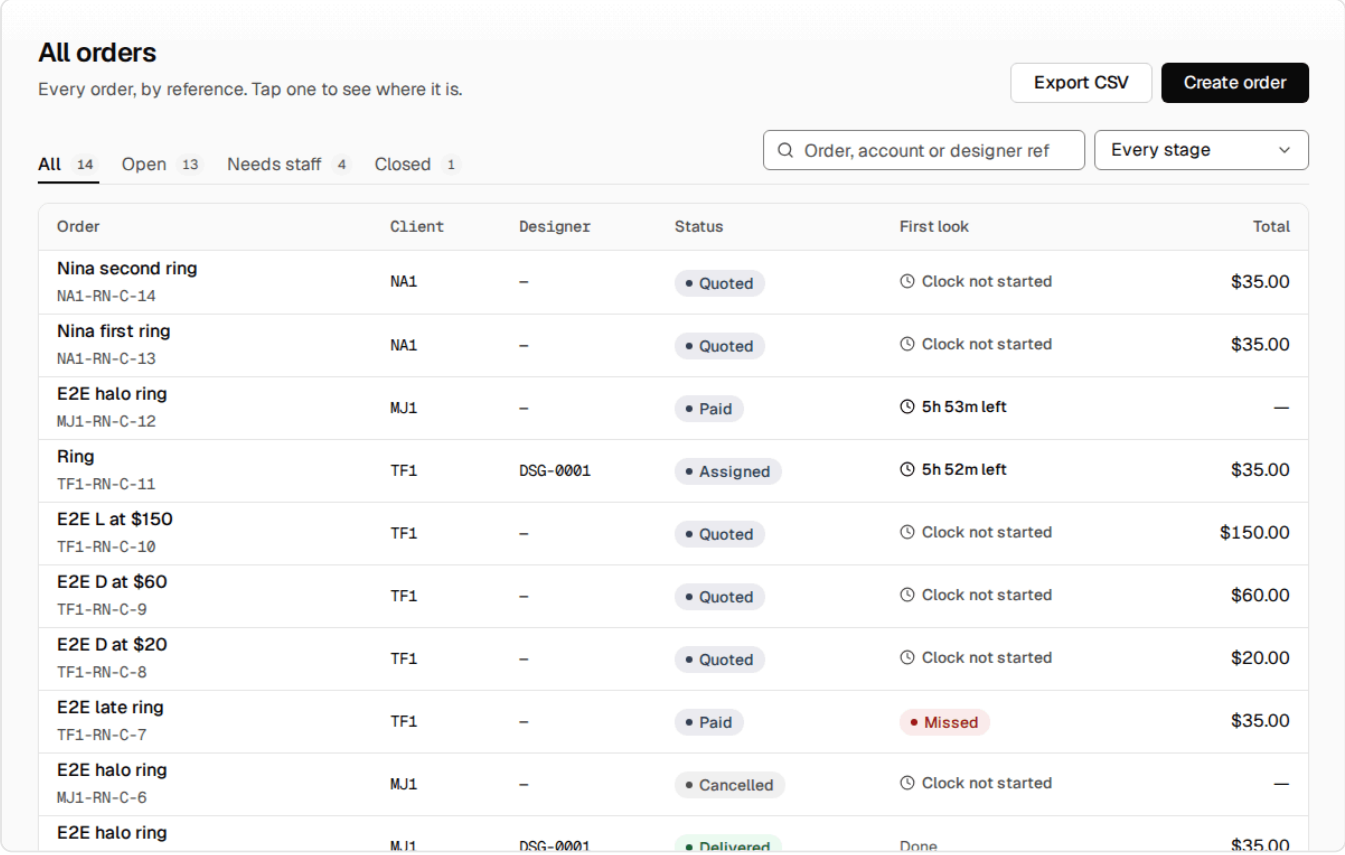
Click anywhere on a row to open the order. An empty Queue says **Queue clear**: nothing needs the team.

All orders

Open: sidebar → **All orders** (`/admin/orders`).

Every order, by reference.

- **Tabs** narrow the list:
  - **All**.
  - **Open**: not finished.
  - **Needs staff**: waiting on the team (Submitted, Paid, In QC review, Disputed, Approved, Delivered).
  - **Closed**: closed, payout released, cancelled or refunded.
- **Search orders** finds by order, account (client code) or designer reference.
- **Every stage** filters by the same stages as the Queue.
- **Save this view** keeps the current tab, search and stage as a named view. Saved views live in this browser only and are not shared with other admins.
- **Export CSV** downloads the orders as a spreadsheet file.
- **Create order** opens the on-behalf form.



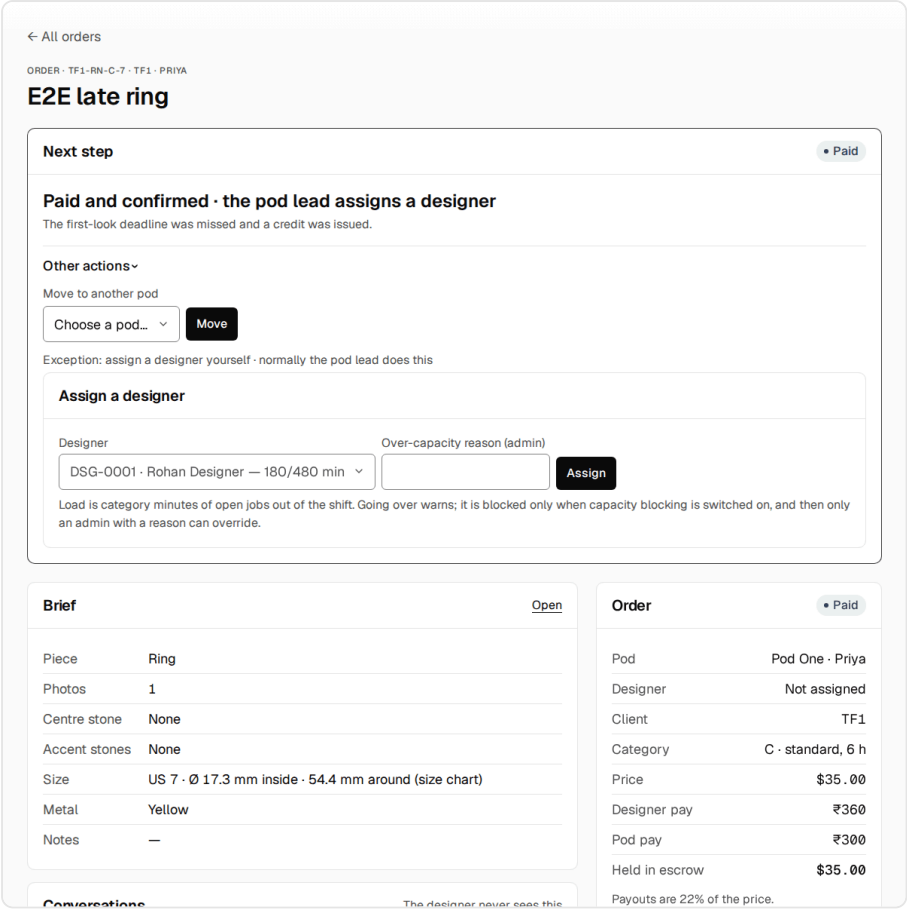
All orders

The order page (team view)

Open: click any order row (Queue, All orders, Billing, a notification).

The team's order page always has the same shape:

1. **Next step** (top). The status pill, one sentence saying where the order stands, the first-look line, and the **one action** the order needs now. Every other action your role may take sits under **Other actions ›**: click it to expand.
2. **Brief.** The client's answers. **Open** shows the full brief with photos.
3. **Conversations.** One card with a **Client** tab and a **Designer** tab ("The designer never sees this" / "The client never sees this").
4. **Files**, **Revisions** and **Timeline** (every recorded event, oldest first).
5. **Order** card (right; below on a phone):
   - **Pod**, **Designer**, **Client** (code), **Category** (with tier and hours);
   - **Price**, **Designer pay**, **Pod pay**, **Held in escrow**;
   - "Payouts are N% of the price", with a warning above 40%;
   - links to the **Full brief**, **Certificate**, **Weight sheet** and **Summary sheet** once QC has passed;
   - the order ID.
6. **Latest activity**, the client's **Master instructions** and any spec claims.



An order ready to assign, with Other actions expanded

What the **Next step** card offers, in priority order:

The order is…	The card offers	Who sees it
Submitted	**Category**, **Price $ (optional)**, **Deadline h (G–L)**, **Set quote**	Sales, Admin
Quoted	**Paid by**, **Reference**, **Mark paid**	Finance, Admin
Paid, no pod	**Choose a pod…** and **Choose**	Admin
Paid, not confirmed	**Confirm order**	Admin, pod lead
Paid and confirmed (admin view)	The sentence "the pod lead assigns a designer"; assigning yourself is under **Other actions**	Admin
In QC review (pod lead)	**Open the QC review**	Pod lead
Approved	**Delivered**	Ops, Admin
Delivered	**Closed**	Ops, Admin
Closed	**Release payout**	Finance as primary role only (why)
Disputed	The **Dispute** panel replaces the card	Ops, Finance

Running an order from start to finish

Each section below is one step of the order's life, in the order it happens. For the whole picture in one table, see Status and handoff table.

Intake: where orders come from

There are two ways in:

1. **The client orders in the portal.** They choose **New order** → **CAD design** (or **Renders**), answer the three brief steps, and press **Send for a price**. The order arrives on the **Queue** as **Awaiting quote**. The client gets the "Order received" email. No one on the team is notified: the Queue is where you see it.
2. **The team places it for them** ("on behalf"), when the request came by email, WhatsApp or phone. See the next section.

A client who wrote to you before having an account can be created in the same form.

Place an order for a client

Who: an Admin or a pod lead. **Before you start:** have at least one screenshot of the client's request (PNG or JPEG).

Open: sidebar → **Create order** (`/admin/new-order`), or **Queue** / **All orders** → **Create order**.

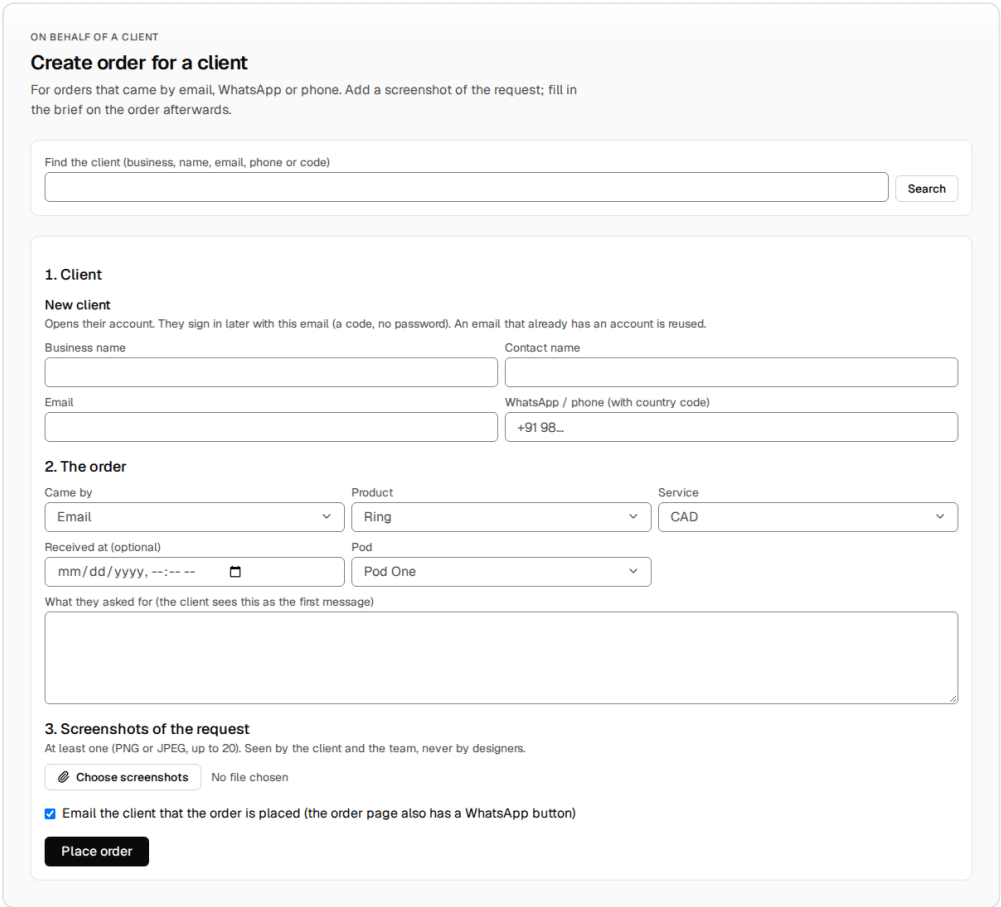
1. **Find the client.** Type their business, name, email, phone or client code into **Find the client…** and click **Search**. Click the right client under **1. Client**.
2. **Or a new client**, if "No client found":
   - Enter **Business name**, **Contact name**, **Email** and **WhatsApp / phone (with country code)**.
   - This opens their account. They later sign in with this email, using a code instead of a password.
   - An email that already has an account is reused, not duplicated.
3. Under **2. The order**, fill in:
   - **Came by**: Email, WhatsApp or Phone.
   - **Product**.
   - **Service**: CAD, Render, or CAD + render.
   - **Received at (optional)**.
   - **Pod**. An admin may leave **No pod yet (admin)**.
4. Under **What they asked for**, write the request. **The client sees this as the first message** in their conversation, so write it for them.
5. Under **3. Screenshots of the request**, click **Choose screenshots** and add at least one (up to 20).
   - The client and the team see them.
   - Designers never do.
6. **Email the client that the order is placed** is ticked by default: the client gets the "Order placed for you" email and an in-app notice. Untick it if you will message them yourself.
7. Click **Place order**.

> **Before you press Place order**
>
> The order goes straight to **Submitted** (Awaiting quote) and appears in the client's portal. With the box ticked, the client is emailed at once. There is no undo: an unwanted order is cancelled by the client, before payment.

What happens next. The order page opens with an **intake panel**:

- how the order came in;
- the screenshots;
- **Send on WhatsApp**, which opens WhatsApp with a ready-written message containing the order link (you still press send there);
- **Write an email**, which opens your email app with the same message.

Fill in the brief on the order (the team may write it for on-behalf orders), then price it. The first-look clock starts only when the order is paid and confirmed.



Create order for a client

Price an order (set a quote)

Who: Sales or Admin. **When:** the order is **Submitted** (Queue: **Awaiting quote**, button **Price it**).

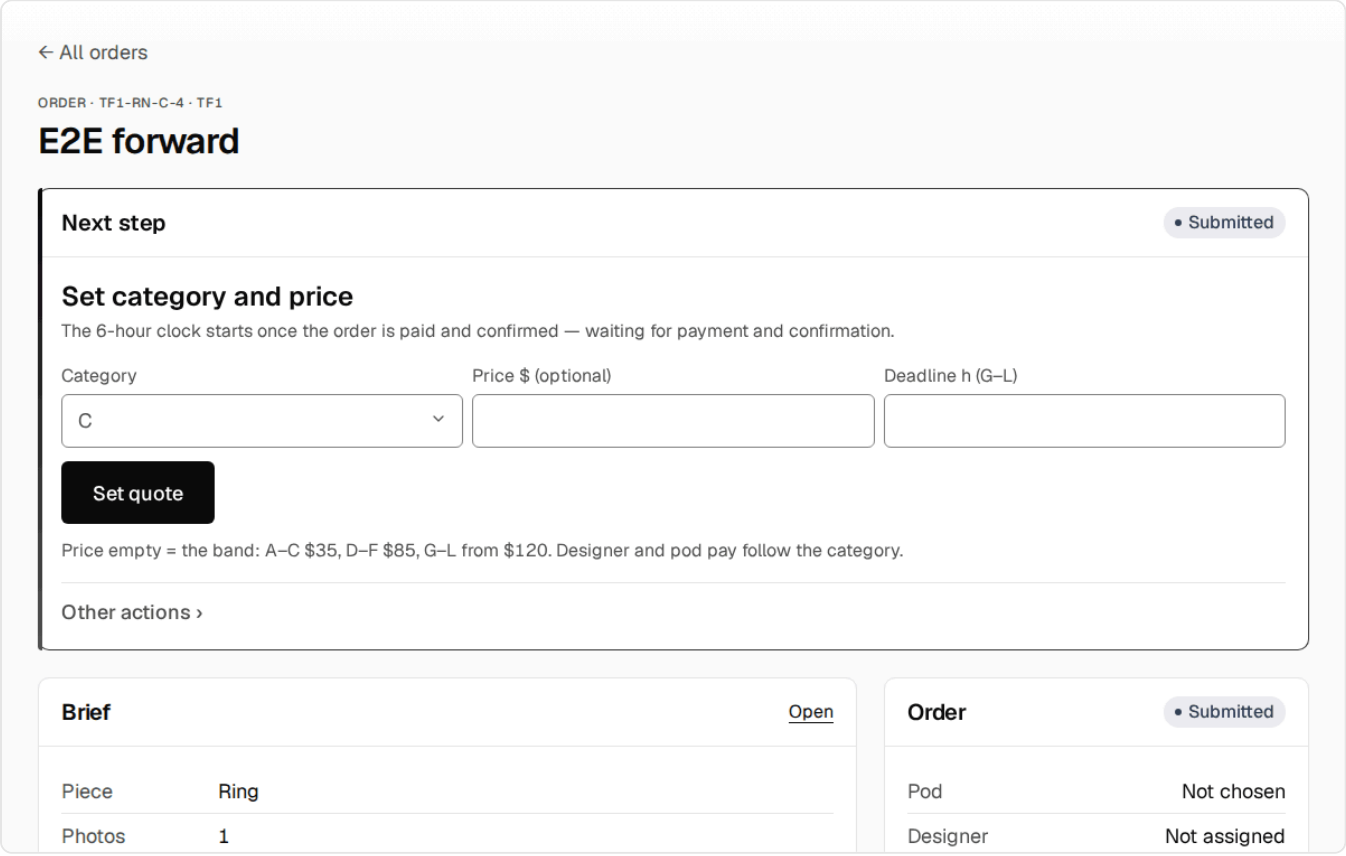
Category	Minutes	Tier	Default price (band)
A, B, C	15, 30, 45	Standard	$35

Category	Minutes	Tier	Default price (band)
D, E, F	60, 90, 120	Standard	$85
G, H, I, J, K, L	180–480	Complex	from $120 (enter the price)

1. Open the order. Read the **Brief** card and any **Master instructions**.
2. In the **Next step** card, choose the **Category** (A–L) from the table above.
3. Leave **Price $ (optional)** empty to use the band price. Or enter the price in US dollars, for example `35` or `120.50`.
4. For G–L only, enter **Deadline h (G–L)**: the hours to the first look. It is required for complex orders.
5. Click **Set quote**.

> **Before you press Set quote**
>
> The price is fixed once set. The app has no re-quote: an order can be priced only while it is **Submitted**. The client is notified and emailed "Quote ready" at once. If the price is wrong, ask the client to **Decline this price** on their Pay screen (that cancels the order), then place it again. Designer pay and pod pay are worked out from the category, so they follow automatically.

Check. The status becomes **Quoted**. The **Order** card shows **Price**, **Designer pay** and **Pod pay**, and "Payouts are N% of the price". If that share is above the **Payout warning** setting (40% by default), the line ends "— above the 40% limit." The warning does not block anything. It is there to stop a loss-making price.



An order waiting for a quote

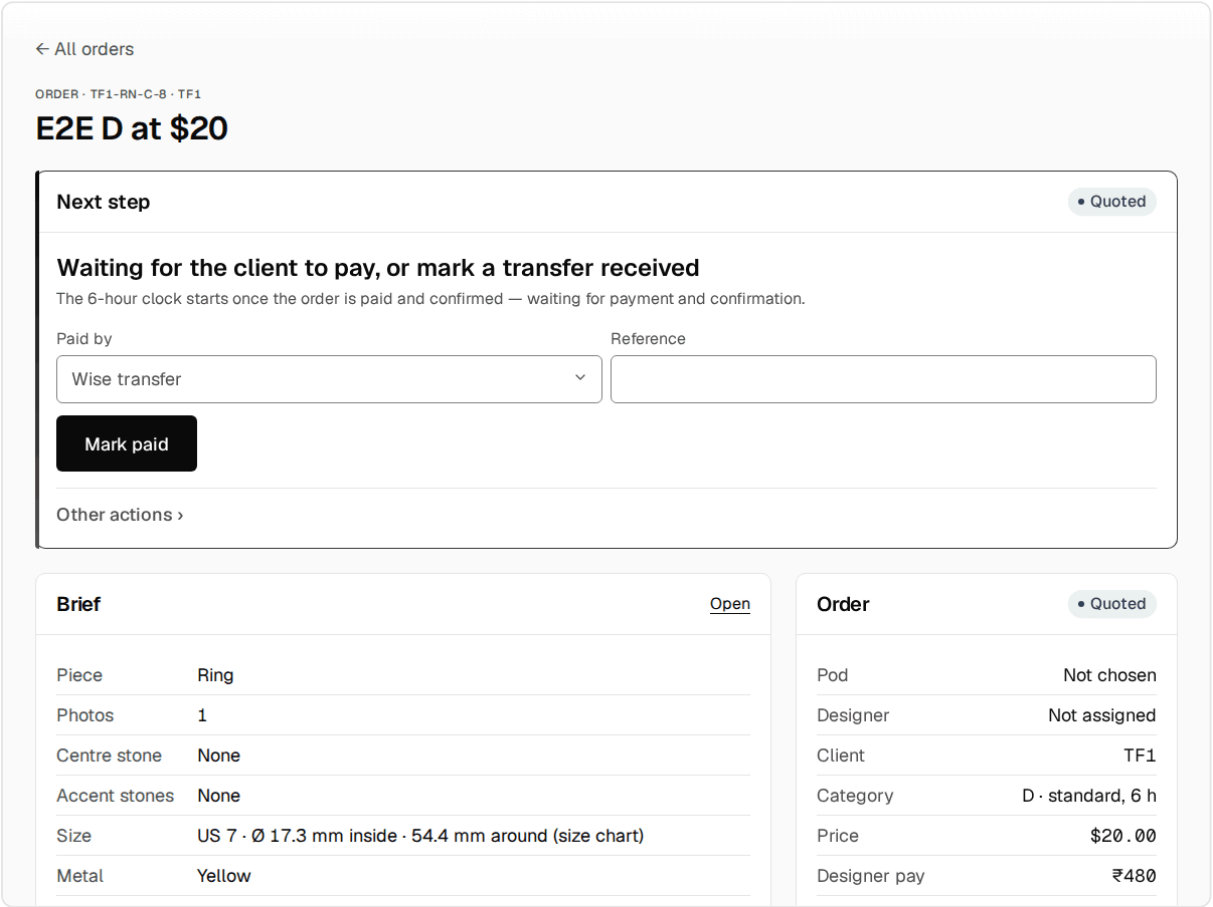
Record a transfer payment

Who: Finance or Admin. **When:** the order is **Quoted** and the money arrived outside the card checkout: a Wise transfer, a bank transfer, PayPal, or another method.

1. Open the order. The **Next step** card shows **Paid by** and **Reference**.
2. Choose **Paid by**: **Wise transfer**, **Bank transfer**, **PayPal** or **Other**.
3. Enter the transfer's **Reference** (up to 120 characters). Your bank or Wise shows it.
4. Click **Mark paid**.

> **Before you press Mark paid**
>
> Only press it when the money is in your account. The order becomes **Paid**, the amount is recorded as held, and the client is emailed "Payment received". There is no "unmark": the only way back is a refund by Finance.

Card and UPI payments need nothing from you. The client presses **Pay & start**. Razorpay confirms the payment to the platform, and the order becomes **Paid** by itself, usually within seconds. If a client says they paid but the order still shows **Quoted**, see troubleshooting.



An order waiting for payment

Choose or change an order's pod

Who: Admin. **When:** the order is paid (or earlier) and has no pod, or you want it in another pod.

- **Automatic:** when an order is paid or confirmed and **exactly one pod has a lead**, it joins that pod by itself.
- **With more than one pod led:** the Queue row reads "Paid · choose a pod". Choose the pod lead in **Choose a pod…**, then click **Choose** (on the Queue row, or in the order's **Next step**).
- **To move it:** open the order → **Other actions ›** → **Move to another pod** → choose → **Move**. This is offered while the order is Submitted, Quoted, Paid or Assigned.

> **Moving a job that already has a designer**
> Moving the pod does not move the designer. If the order is **Assigned**, first take it back, then move the pod, so the new pod lead can assign one of their own designers.

Confirm the order (start the clock)

Who: Admin or the order's pod lead. **When:** the brief is complete and any open questions are answered. This is possible from Submitted until In progress, once per order.

1. Open the order.
2. Click **Confirm order**. It is in the **Next step** card when the order is paid and has a pod; otherwise it is under **Other actions ›**.

> **Before you press Confirm order**
> If the order is already paid, the first-look clock starts now: 6 hours for categories A–F, or the hours set with the price for G–L. The client is notified and emailed "Order confirmed" with the due time, and the pod lead is notified. Confirmation cannot be undone.

Check: the **First look** column on the Queue shows a countdown, and the order says "First look due by …".

Assign a designer (admin exception)

Assigning is the pod lead's job. The admin's page says "Paid and confirmed · the pod lead assigns a designer". Assign yourself only when the pod lead cannot: absent, or about to miss the clock.

Before you start:

- the order is **Paid**, confirmed, in a pod, and **has no designer**;
- the designer is in that pod and is assignable (what that means).

1. Open the order → **Other actions ›** → **Exception: assign a designer yourself · normally the pod lead does this**.
2. Choose the **Designer**. Each option reads "DSG-reference · Name — open/shift min". Greyed options marked **(not signed up)** cannot be chosen.
3. If the job would push the designer over their shift (480 category minutes by default), enter an **Over-capacity reason (admin)**. While **Block assignment over shift capacity** is off (the default), going over only warns.
4. Click **Assign**.

What happens:

- The status becomes **Assigned**.
- The designer is notified "You have been assigned to an order."
- Designer pay and pod pay are reset at this designer's rate (recorded in the audit history).

An order can be assigned only once. To change designer later, move it.

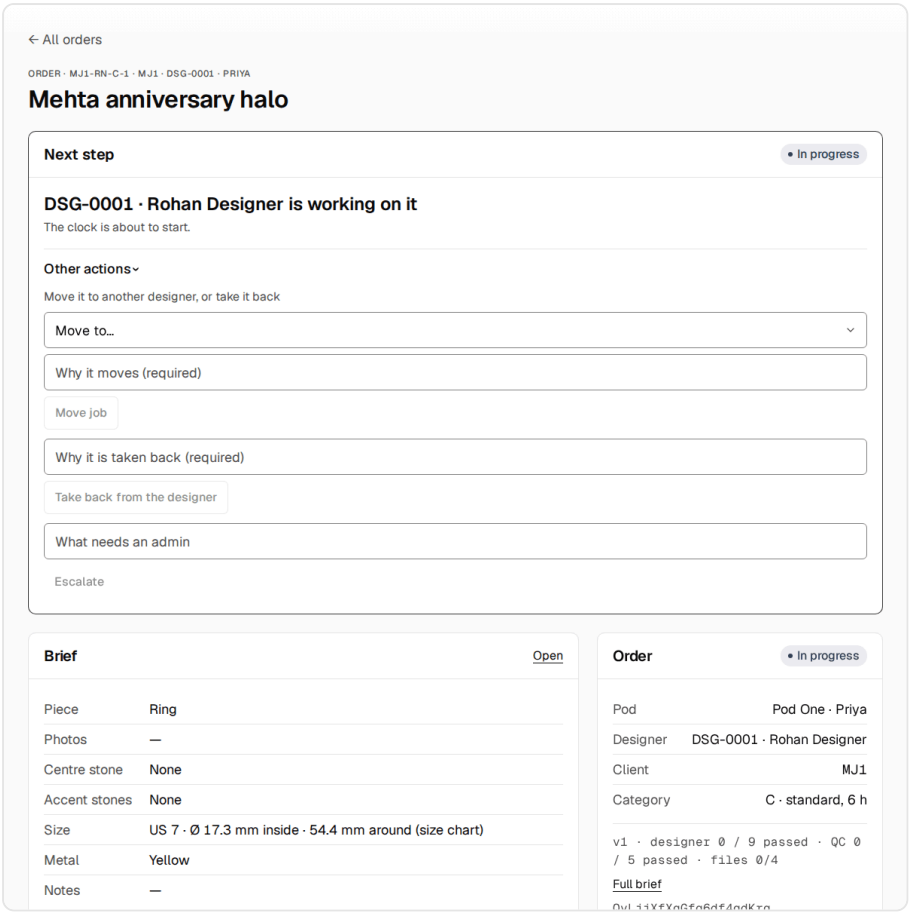
Move a job to another designer, or take it back

Who: the order's pod lead, or an Admin. **When:** the job is **Assigned**, **In progress** or **Revision requested**.

Open: the order → **Other actions ›** → **Move it to another designer, or take it back**. A pod lead also has the same controls on the **Team board**, under each job card → **Move, take back or escalate**.

- **Move:**
  1. Choose **Move to…** (only designers in the same pod are offered).
  2. Write **Why it moves**. A reason is required once work has started (status In progress or Revision requested); it is optional while the job is only Assigned.
  3. Click **Move job**.
  4. The new designer must press **Start work**.
  5. The old designer is notified "A job was moved to another designer".
- **Take back:**
  1. Write **Why it is taken back** (required once work has started).
  2. Click **Take back from the designer**.
  3. The order returns to **Paid** with no designer, and waits for a designer again.
  4. The designer is notified, and so is every admin.

> **Pay follows the job**
>
> Moving a job resets designer pay to the new designer's rate. The designer's paused time is closed off, so their clock history stays correct.



An order with a designer: Move and Take back under Other actions

Resolve an escalation

A pod lead escalates a job when it needs an admin (from the Team board: **Escalate**, with "What needs an admin"). Every admin is notified "A pod lead escalated a job", and the Queue shows "N jobs escalated by a pod lead" → **Review**.

1. Click **Review**. It opens **Performance** with the **Escalated to admin** list.
2. Read the reason and do what is needed. Usually that is messaging the designer, moving the job, or answering the client.
3. Type what you did in the **What was done** box and click **Resolve**. The pod lead is notified "An admin resolved your escalation".

Follow QC and the client's review

Admins watch this stage; they do not perform it.

- **Designer sends to QC.** The order goes straight to **In QC review**. The pod lead is notified, and the client is told "Work has been submitted on your order."
- **Pod lead's review.** The pod lead marks five **QC manager** lines **Pass** or **Fail** and, for CAD, records the measured specification. Then:
  - **Approve · pass to client**: the order becomes **Ready to preview** and the first-look clock stops. The first look counts as on time if it happens before the deadline.

    - **Send back · revision needed**: the order becomes **Revision requested**. The failed lines become the designer's notes. A send-back does not use up the client's rounds.
- **Client's review.** The client can **Approve this design**, **Send changes** (two rounds included within 14 days of the first look), or **Raise a problem**. After the rounds are used, a change is a **new order** ("Order a change"), priced separately; it notifies the pod lead "…It needs a quote." and appears on the Queue.

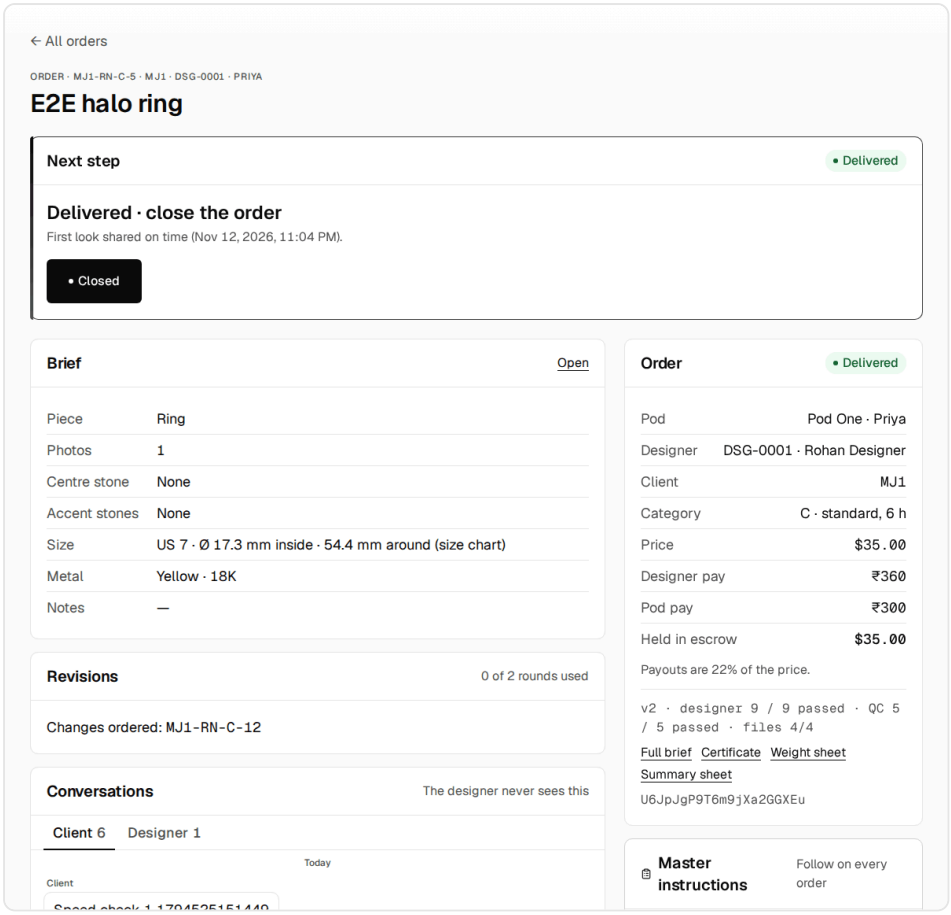
> **Admins cannot pass or fail QC from the screen**
>
> The QC review page is the pod lead's. If a pod lead is absent, move the order to another pod (before assignment), or have technical support give a team member the pod-lead role for that pod.

Deliver and close

Who: Ops or Admin.

1. When the client approves, the Queue row reads "Client approved · deliver the files" with **Deliver**. Open the order and click **Delivered** in **Next step**.
    - The order becomes **Delivered**.
    - The client is notified and emailed "Files delivered".
    - Their files are already unlocked: they unlock at approval.
2. When nothing more is owed to the client, open the order and click **Closed**. The Queue row says "Delivered · close the order".

> **Before you press Closed**
>
> Closing finishes the order. It makes the designer's pay and the pod lead's pay **owed**, and they appear on **Payouts**. It cannot be reopened. The client's spec-claim window (30 days from delivery) is not affected.



A delivered order, ready to close

Cancel an order or refund a client

Situation	Who	How
Draft not wanted	Client	Order → ⋯ (More) → **Delete draft**
Sent or quoted, not paid	Client	Order → ⋯ → **Cancel order**, or **Decline this price** on the Pay screen
Paid, work not wanted	Finance	Order → **Other actions ›** → **Refund client** (offered while **Paid** or **Disputed**)
Disputed and cannot be fixed	Finance	**Dispute** panel → **Refund the client…** (disputes)

The team has no "cancel" button for an unpaid order: the client cancels it.

> **Refund and Release appear only for a primary Finance role**
>
> **Refund client**, **Refund the client…** and **Release payout** are shown only when the person's *primary* role is **Finance**. A full Admin whose primary role is Ops does not see them, although the database would allow them. Have a Finance-primary team member do refunds, or ask technical support. The same rule shows **Send back for rework** only to a primary **Ops** role.

Resolve a dispute

A client raises a problem from their order → ⋯ → **Raise a problem** (while the order is **In progress** or **Ready to preview**). The order becomes **Disputed** and freezes. The client sees "We're looking into a problem", and is emailed. The designer is notified. The Queue shows "N disputes open…" → **Show**, and the row's reason is the client's own words.

1. Open the order. The **Dispute** panel shows "Dispute open" and the client's reason.
2. Talk to the client in the **Client** conversation before deciding.
3. Decide:
   - **Send back for rework** (Ops). The order returns to **In progress** with the same designer. The client and designer are told it was resolved.
   - **Refund the client…** (Finance). A confirmation asks you to type `refund`.

> **Before you confirm Refund the client**
> "The full amount goes back to the client and the order closes. This cannot be undone." The client is emailed "Order refunded".

Decide a late first-look credit

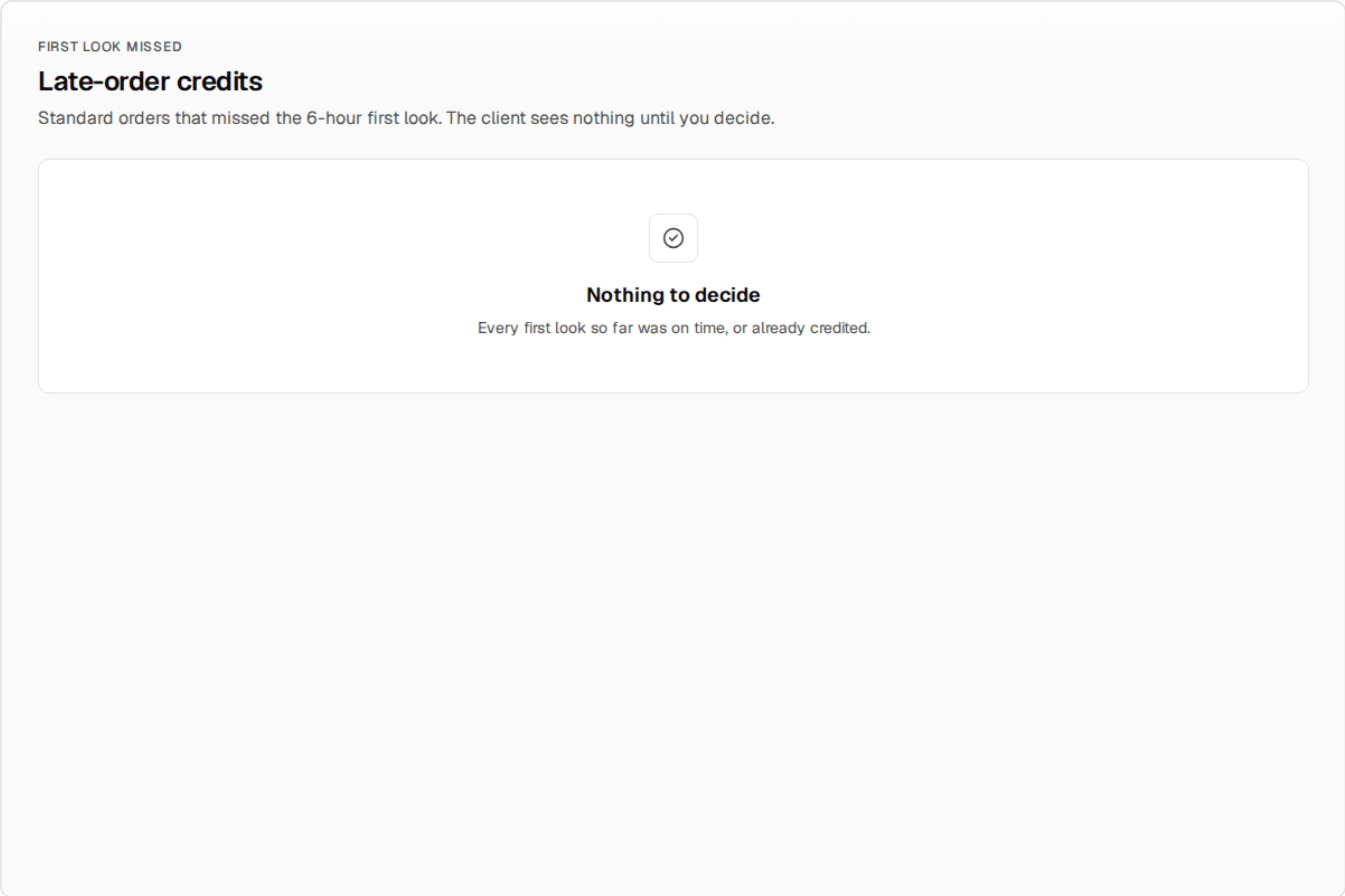
When a **standard** order (A–F) misses its 6-hour first look, the platform creates one pending credit for the full amount paid. It does this once, however many times the check runs. The client is emailed "Order delayed". The credit waits for you; the client sees nothing about it until you decide. Complex orders are not credited.

Open: Queue alert "First look missed…" → **Decide**, or **Billing** → **Credits** (`/admin/credits`).

1. Each row shows the order, the amount, and when it "was due".
2. Choose the **Decision**:
   - **Apply to next order**: the credit comes off their next order.
   - **Refund**.
   - **Partial credit**: enter **Amount $ (partial)** and a reason.
   - **Reject**: a reason is required.
3. Use **Reason (partial / reject)** where needed.
4. Click **Decide**.

The client is notified and emailed "Credit decided". The same credit cannot be decided twice: a second tab is refused.

> **"Refund" records the decision; it does not move money**
> Deciding **Refund** marks the credit refunded and tells the client. It does not send money back. Make the refund yourself in the Razorpay dashboard, or by bank transfer for transfer payments. A credit applied to the next order shows in the client's **Wallet** as **Credit**. The team takes it off the next price.



Late-order credits

Decide a spec claim

After delivery the client may open a spec claim, for example "Wall thinner than the certificate says". They do it from the order → **Spec guarantee** → **A file broke its spec sheet? Open a claim**, within 30 days, one at a time. They upload the file they cast from and photos. The pod lead is notified to re-measure, and the Queue shows the claim with **Review**.

1. **Review** opens the order's **Spec claims** panel. It shows whether **the file matches** the version delivered (an edited file is not covered), plus the casting details, **Their file** and **Photo**.
2. Enter the **Re-measured value** and a **Decision note**.
3. Click **Uphold · free fix + credit** or **Spec met · reject**.

Upholding creates a free fix order (the pod lead is notified to assign it, with the 6-hour clock running) and credits the CAD fee to the client's next order. Rejecting tells the client the result. The pod lead or an admin may decide.

Write master instructions for a client

A client's **Master instructions** are their factory's standing rules. The designer, the pod lead and admins see them on every order. The client normally writes them on **Account**.

To write or correct them for the client:

1. Open any of the client's orders.

2. In the **Master instructions** card (right column), click **Edit for this client**. The link reads **Add for this client** if there are none yet.
3. Change the text (up to 4,000 characters).
4. Click **Save for every order of this client**.

Issue a missing QC certificate

After QC passes, the **Order** card links **Certificate**, **Weight sheet** and **Summary sheet**. If a CAD order has no certificate yet, an **Issue certificate** button appears there. Click it to make the certificate from the recorded QC.

People: clients, designers, pod leads and staff

Exists versus can receive work

A person can be on the platform for days without being able to do anything useful. Work reaches a designer only when **every** row of this table is true:

#	Condition	Where you see it	Set by
1	A sign-in account exists for their email	**Access** lists them	**Designers** → **Add designers**, or the person signing up
2	Their role is **Designer**	**Access** → Role	**Add designers** sets it
3	They have signed in and signed the **current** designer agreement	**Designers**: status **Active** (not **Waiting to sign in**); **Pods**: no "Not signed" tag	The designer, on their first sign-in
4	Their status is **Active**, not **Suspended**	**Access** → Status	Signing the agreement makes it Active; Ops or an Admin can suspend
5	They are in a pod	**Designers**: Pod is not "Not in a pod"	An Admin, on the designer's page or on **Pods**
6	The order is in **that** pod	The order's **Pod**	Automatic, or an Admin (choose a pod)
7	They have room in the shift (only if capacity blocking is on)	Load "270/480 min" in the assign list	**Settings** → **Designer capacity per shift**

What each person sees in between:

Moment	Admin sees	Pod lead sees	Designer sees
Added, not yet signed in	**Designers**: "Waiting to sign in"; **Access**: Pending	Nothing, until the designer is in their pod. Then the name shows greyed out: "· not signed" (Team board) / "(not signed up)" (order page)	Nothing (they have not signed in)
Signed in, agreement not signed	Same	Same	**Home**: "Finish onboarding · Sign the designer agreement…" → **Continue**
Agreement signed, no pod	**Designers**: Active, "Not in a pod"; page header warns "…not in a pod yet: their pod lead cannot see or assign them"	Nothing	**Home**: "No open jobs"
Active and in a pod	**Designers**: Active, pod name	The name in **Assign to…**, selectable, with their load	Jobs once assigned
Suspended	**Access**: Suspended	Greyed out: "not signed" / "(not signed up)" (the same tag is reused)	Their actions are refused

> **When the agreement text changes**
>
> A designer must have signed the **current** version. Publishing a new version of the designer agreement makes every designer unassignable until they sign again: the onboarding page asks them to.

Designer applications

Who: Ops, Sales or Admin. **Open:** sidebar → **Applications** (`/admin/applications`).

Applications come from the website form (**apply-designer**). Each card shows:

- the applicant, their years of experience, **Email**, **Phone** and **Categories**;
- when they **Applied**;
- the **Portfolio** link and any uploaded files.

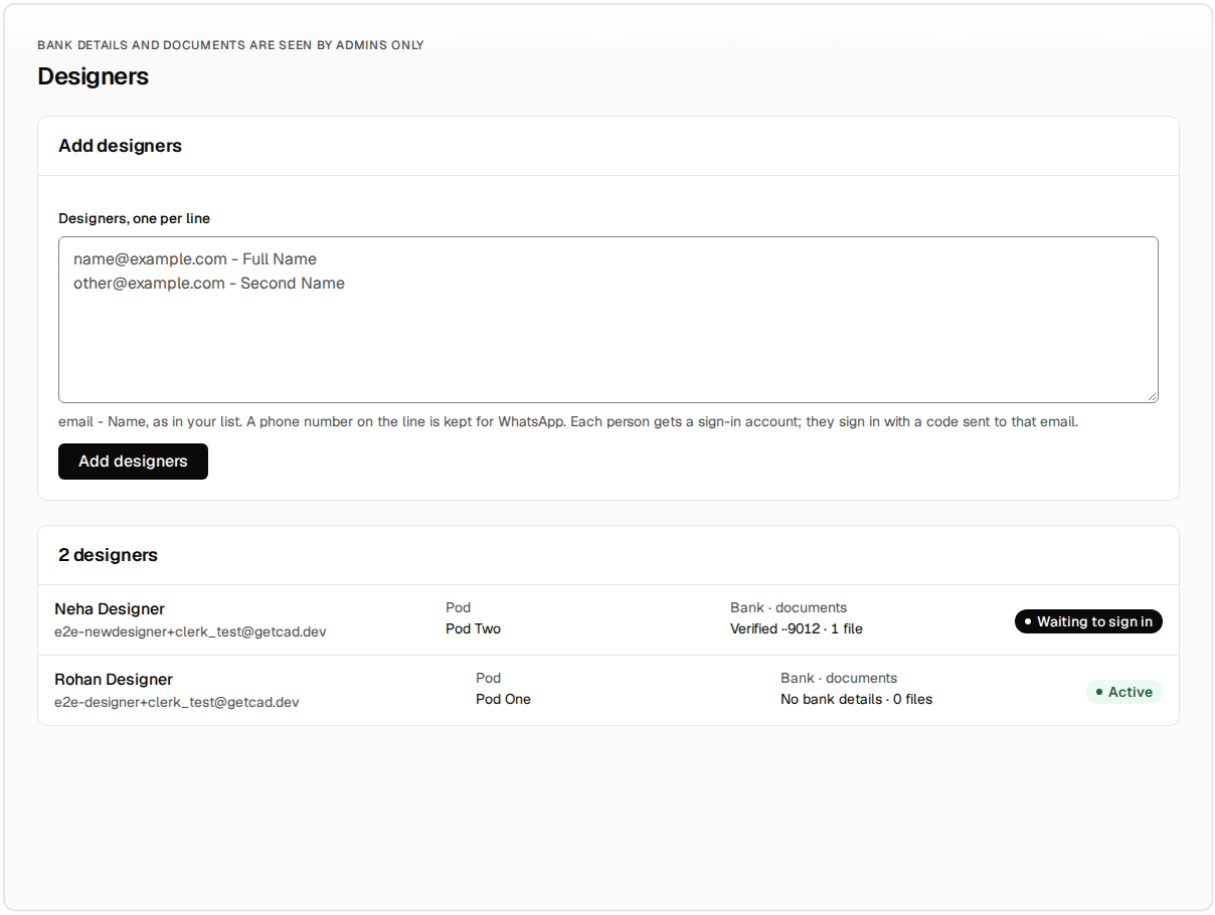
Tabs: **To review**, **Accepted**, **Rejected**, **All**.

1. Read the card and open the portfolio.
2. Optionally write a **Review note**. A note is required to reject: "Add a short note on why, so the decision is legible later."
3. Click **Accept** or **Reject**. **Reopen** puts a decided application back to **To review**.

> **Accepting does not create an account**
>
> **Accept** only emails the applicant that you will "follow up… with the details and how to set up your account". It does not create a login. To bring them on, follow Add designers with the same email, then send them the sign-in instructions.

Add designers and get them working

Who: Admin. **Open:** sidebar → **More** → **Designers** (`/admin/designers`).



Designers: add by list; every designer's pod, bank details and status

1. In **Add designers**, paste one designer per line as `email - Name`, for example `designer@example.com - Ravi Kumar`. A phone number on the line is kept for WhatsApp.
2. Click **Add designers**.
   - The result lists **Added**, **Already on file**, and any line it could not read.
   - Each person gets a sign-in account with role Designer and status **Pending**.
   - An email that belongs to a client or team account is refused.
3. **Tell each designer to sign in.**

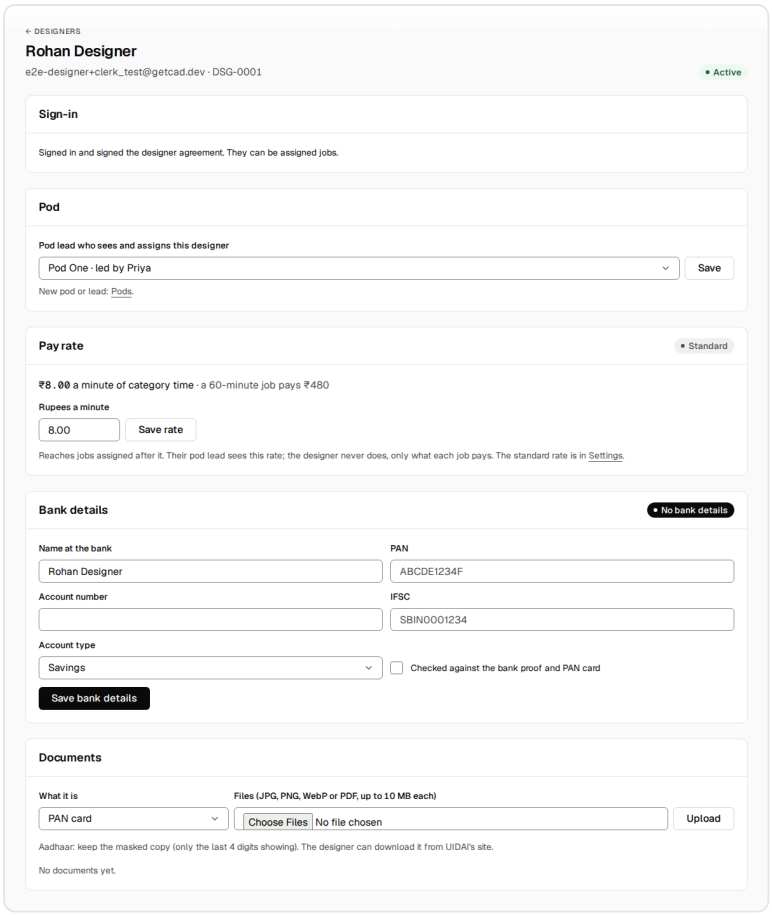
> **No invitation email is sent**
>
> Adding a designer creates the account silently. Send them the line from their page: "sign in at thecadpillar.com/sign-in with *their email*. A code arrives by email. Then sign the designer agreement."

4. Click the designer's name to open their page, then:
   - place them in a pod;
   - record bank details;
   - optionally set an own rate.
5. When they sign the agreement, their status becomes **Active**. If they are in a pod, the pod lead can now assign them.

The list shows each designer's name and email, **Pod**, **Bank · documents** and status:

- Bank: **No bank details**, **To check ··1234**, **Verified ··1234**, **Rejected**.

- Status: **Waiting to sign in**, **Active**, **Pending**, **Suspended**.



A designer's page: sign-in status, pod, pay rate, bank details and documents

Place a designer in a pod, or remove them

On the designer's page → **Pod** → choose **Pod lead who sees and assigns this designer** → **Save**. Choose **Not in a pod** to take them out. You can also do this on **Pods** (below). A designer is in one pod at a time.

> **What the pod lead gains**
>
> Placing a designer in a pod is what makes the pod lead able to see them, assign them, and see their pay rate. Nothing else does.

Set a designer's own pay rate

On the designer's page → **Pay rate**:

1. Enter **Rupees a minute** (for example `9.50`).
2. Click **Save rate**.
3. To go back to the standard rate, click **Back to standard (₹8.00)**. It appears only while an own rate is set. The card's pill reads **Own rate** or **Standard**.

The new rate reaches jobs assigned **after** the change; jobs already assigned keep their pay. The pod lead sees the rate but cannot change it. The designer never sees a rate, only what each job pays. The standard rate (₹8 a minute) is in Settings.

Record bank details and identity documents

Only admins see these, and every full view and document open is logged.

- **Bank details**, on the designer's page:
  1. Enter **Name at the bank**, **PAN** (format `ABCDE1234F`), **Account number**, **IFSC** (format `SBIN0001234`) and **Account type** (Savings or Current).
  2. Tick **Checked against the bank proof and PAN card** once you have verified them.
  3. Click **Save bank details** (**Replace bank details** if some exist).
  4. Saved details show masked. **Show in full** reveals them once ("Each view is recorded in the audit log."); **Hide** masks them again.
- **Documents:**
  1. Under **What it is**, choose **PAN card**, **Aadhaar (masked copy)**, **Bank proof (cheque or passbook)**, **Photo** or **Other**.
  2. Choose the **Files** (JPG, PNG, WebP or PDF, up to 10 MB each).
  3. Click **Upload**.
  4. Each document has **Open** and **Remove**. Removing deletes the file.
  5. Keep only the masked Aadhaar: the last 4 digits showing.

A designer can also enter their own bank details under **Account** → **Payout details**. Saving new details sends them for checking again.

Pod leads and pods

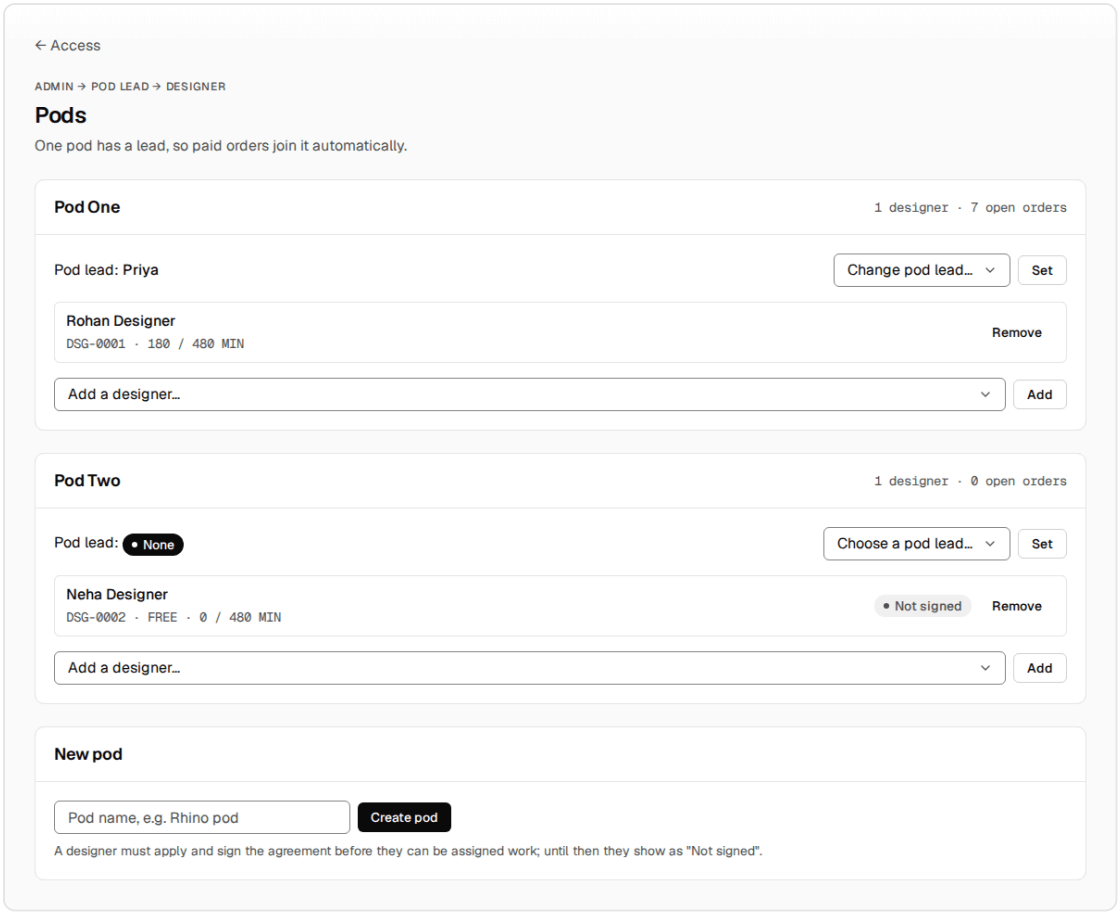
Make someone a pod lead

1. The person signs in once, which creates their account.
2. **Access** → find them → set **Role** to **Pod lead**.
3. The platform creates their pod straight away, named after their first name, for example "Masud's pod".
4. If a pod lead somehow has no pod, **Access** → **Pods** lists them under **Pod leads without a pod** with **Create their pod**.

A pod lead without a pod can receive no orders and has no designers.

Create a pod, change its lead, add or remove designers

Open: Access → **Pods** (`/admin/access/pods`). Admin only.



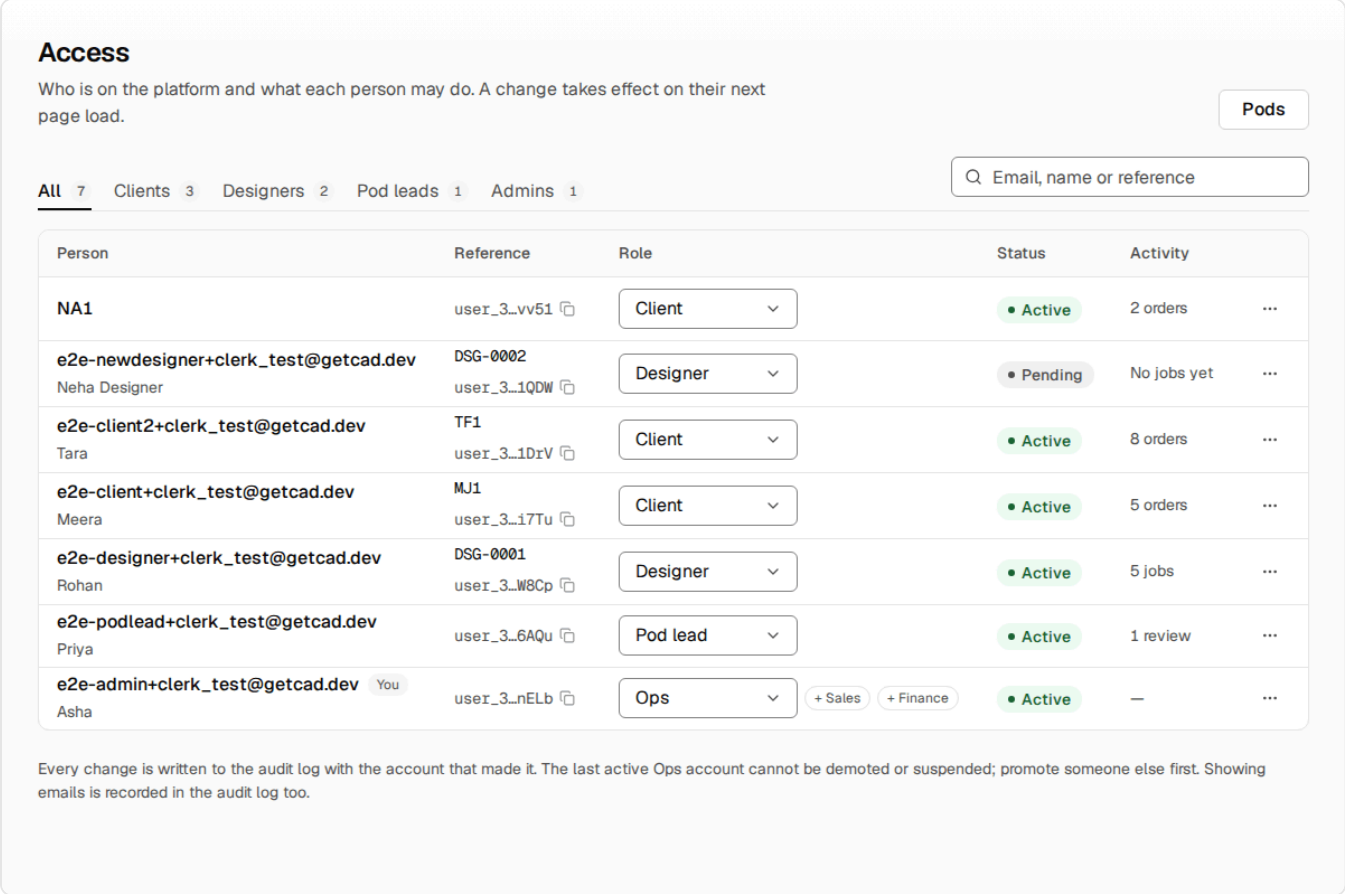
Pods: each pod's lead and designers; new pods at the bottom

- The header says how routing works now:
  - "One pod has a lead, so paid orders join it automatically."
  - Or: "With more than one pod, each paid order waits in the Queue until you choose its pod."
- Each pod shows its **designer** and **open order** counts and its **Pod lead**.
  - To change the lead: **Change pod lead…** → **Set**.
  - Designers who have not signed the agreement carry **Not signed**.
  - **Remove** takes a designer out of the pod.
  - **Add a designer…** → **Add** puts one in.
- **New pod:** type the name (for example "Rhino pod") → **Create pod**. Then set its lead and add designers.

> **Before you add a second led pod**
>
> While exactly one pod has a lead, paid orders route to it by themselves. The moment a second pod has a lead, every paid order waits on the Queue ("Paid · choose a pod") until an admin chooses.

Staff accounts and roles (Access)

Who: Ops or Admin. **Open:** sidebar → **Access** (`/admin/access`).



Access: every account with its role and status

- **Tabs: All**, **Clients**, **Designers**, **Pod leads**, **Admins** (Ops, Sales and Finance).
- **Search accounts** by email, name or reference (ACC… for clients, DSG… for designers).
- **Each row:**
  - the person, with **You** on your own row;
  - their reference;
  - the **Role** menu, with any additional roles as "+ Sales" tags;
  - the status pill;
  - ⋯ (More).
- **Pods** (top) opens the pod screen.

Emails and names come from the sign-in service, and each look-up is logged. If that fails, the page says "Couldn't load emails — showing account references only".

Change someone's role

1. Find the person. They must have signed in at least once.
2. Choose the new **Role**: **Client**, **Designer**, **Pod lead**, **Ops**, **Sales** or **Finance**.
3. The change saves at once (a message confirms it) and applies on their next page load.

Before you change a role

The change is logged with your account. The **last active Ops account cannot be demoted or suspended**: promote someone else first. Changing a designer to another role makes them unassignable. Making someone **Pod lead** creates a pod for them.

Make someone a full Admin

A full Admin needs Sales, Ops and Finance. The Access screen sets only one, the primary role.

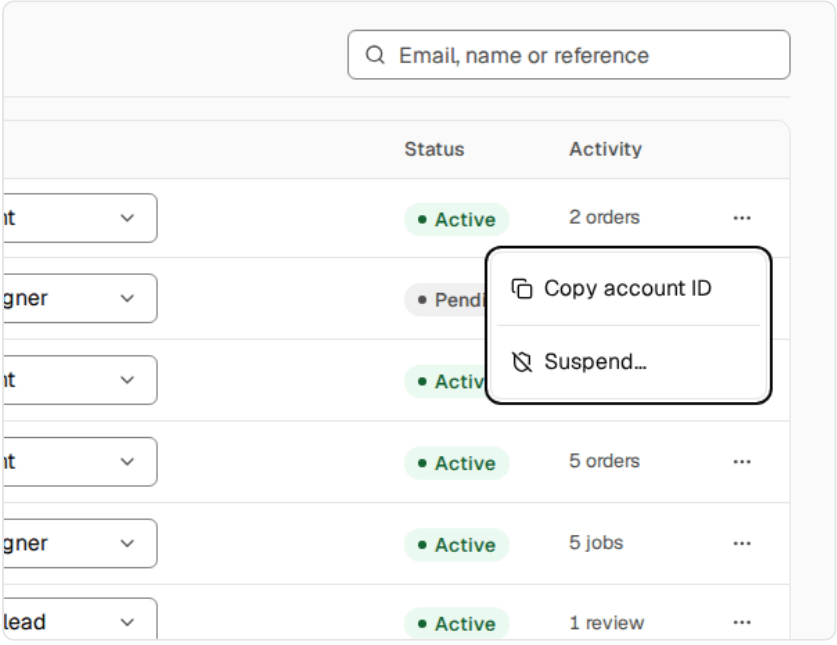
1. Set their primary role on **Access**. Choose **Ops**: refunds and releases then need a Finance-primary person; see why.
2. Ask technical support to add the other two roles as additional roles.
3. Check: the person's **Account** page lists all three, and **Access** shows "+ Sales" "+ Finance" tags.

Not on any screen

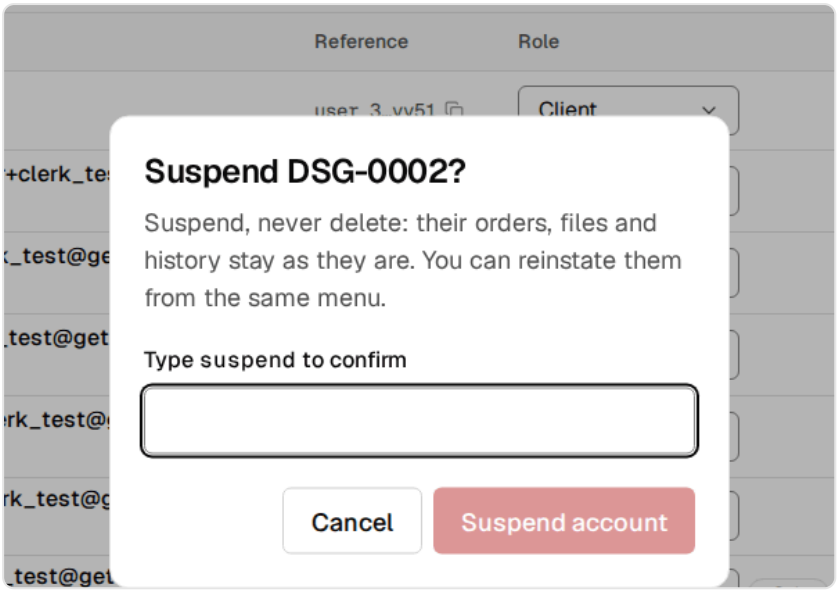
Additional roles cannot be granted or removed from the portal. Treat the request as a support ticket, and say who approved it.

Suspend or reinstate an account

1. **Access** → the person's row → ⋯ (More) → **Suspend…**.
2. Read the dialog: "Suspend, never delete: their orders, files and history stay as they are. You can reinstate them from the same menu."
3. Type `suspend` in **Type suspend to confirm**. The button stays disabled until you do.
4. Click **Suspend account**.
5. To undo it: ⋯ → **Reinstate**.



The row menu: Copy account ID, Suspend…



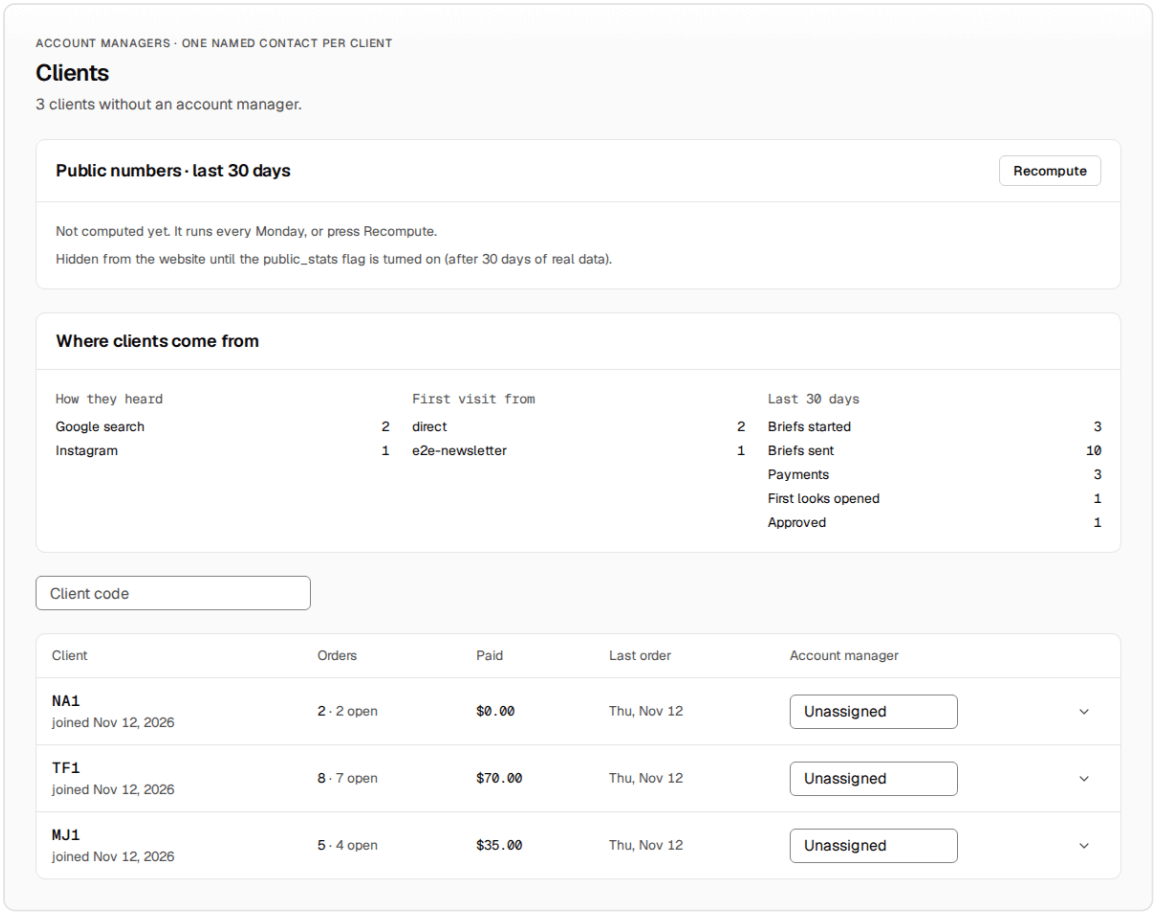
Suspending asks first; nothing is deleted

··· → **Copy account ID** copies the internal ID, which technical support asks for.

A suspended designer cannot be assigned. Jobs they already hold stay with them until you move or take them back.

Clients

Open: sidebar → **Clients** (`/admin/clients`). Admin only.



Clients

- **Public numbers · last 30 days.** These are the figures the public **Results** page would show:
  - first looks on time, approved first time, late credits, claims upheld, designs delivered.
  - They are computed every Monday; **Recompute** updates them now.
  - They stay hidden from the website until the **Public results page** switch is on (Settings).
- **Where clients come from:**
  - **How they heard** (asked at sign-up);
  - **First visit from** (the first web link or campaign);
  - **Last 30 days**: Briefs started, Briefs sent, Payments, First looks opened, Approved.
- **Search by client code.**
- **The table:**
  - **Client** (code and join date);
  - **Orders** (and how many open);
  - **Paid** (US dollars);
  - **Last order**;
  - **Account manager**.

Name an account manager. Choose a team member in the client's **Account manager** menu. It saves at once ("NJ1 is now looked after by …"). Choose **Unassigned** to clear it. The header counts clients without one.

Client names are not on this page; clients are listed by code. To find a client by name, email or phone, use the search on **Create order**.

Website contact leads

Who: Ops, Sales or Admin. **Open:** sidebar → **Leads** (`/admin/leads`).

Messages from the website contact form, with name, email, what they are ("Jewelry business", "CAD designer", "Other") and the message. Tabs: **New**, **Handled**, **All**.

1. Reply from your own email.
2. Click **Mark handled**. **Reopen** brings it back to **New**.

Messages, files and visibility

Two conversations per order

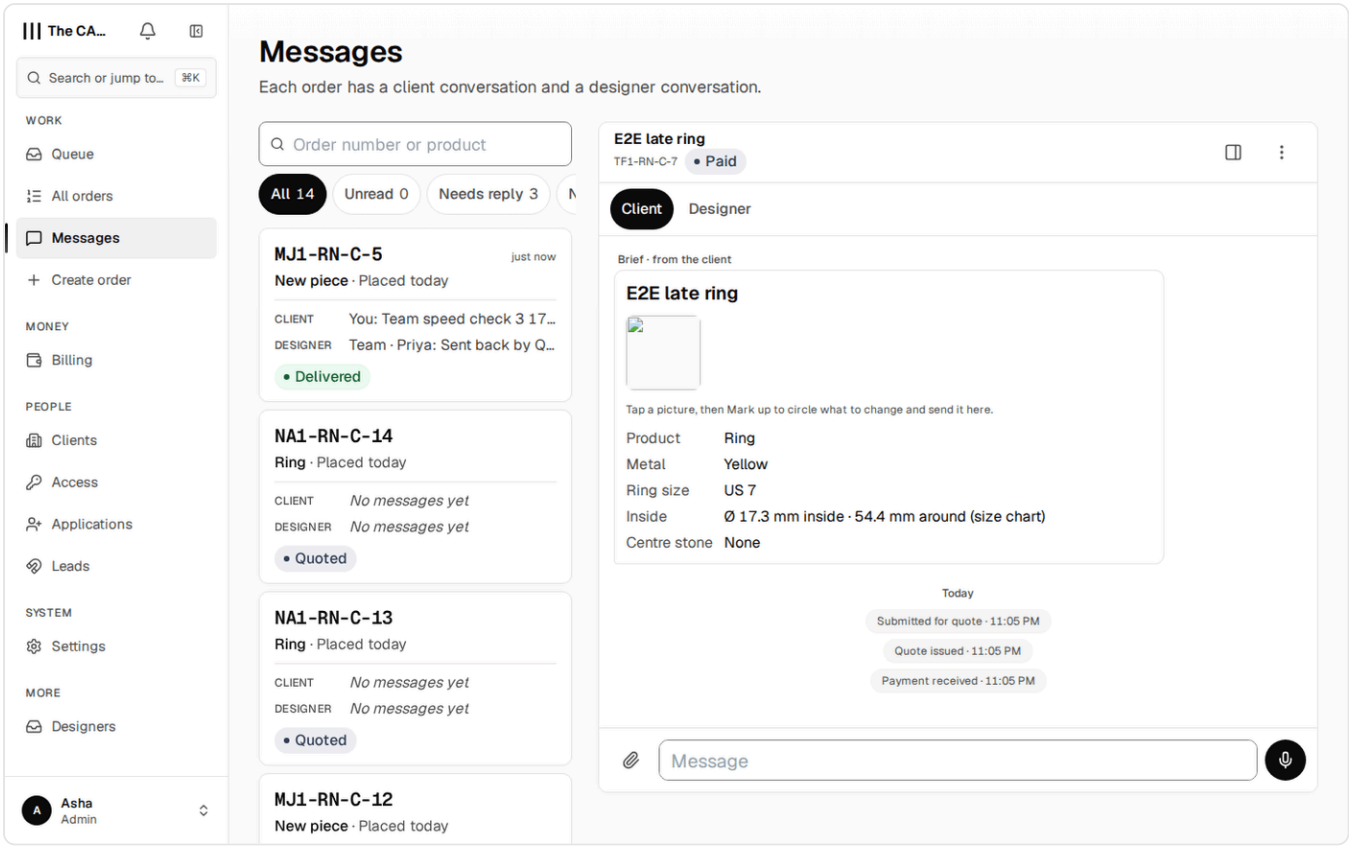
Every order has two separate conversations. The database keeps them apart.

Tab on the order	Members	Never seen by	Notes
Client tab (client ↔ team)	The client; the pod lead; admins	**The designer**	To the client, every team message comes from **"Your team"**. Team members see each other as "Team · first name". Opens with the client's brief as the first message.
Designer tab (team ↔ designer)	The designer; the pod lead; admins	**The client**	The designer's copy of the brief never names the client.
Old messages	Admins only	Everyone else	Read-only messages from before the current chat (version 1). Shown only when they exist.

Messages

Open: sidebar → **Messages** (`/messages`). On an order, the conversations are also in the **Conversations** card.

- **The list** shows every order's conversation, with the latest message and an unread count.
  - Filters, each with a count: **All**, **Unread**, **Needs reply** (the client or designer wrote last), **No messages**.
  - **Search conversations** by order number or product.
- **The conversation:**
  - **All conversations** (back, on a phone);
  - the order title;
  - the order-details button, which opens **Brief**, **Files** and **Open the order**.



An order's conversation, team view

Writing a message

1. Choose the tab: **Client** (the conversation with the client) or **Designer** (the conversation with the designer).
2. Type in **Message**.
    - **Attach** (paper clip) offers **Camera**, **Photos** or **File** (up to 25 MB each).
    - The microphone records a **voice message**.
3. Click **Send** (the arrow).
    - A tick shows **Sent**; a double tick shows **Read**.
    - A failed message says "Not sent · Tap to retry".

Marking up a picture. Open any picture in the conversation, the brief's included, and click **Mark up**. Draw in one of three ways:

- drag around an area to circle it (the default);
- draw freehand;
- tap to drop numbered pins.

Undo and **Clear** correct mistakes. **Done** attaches the marked-up copy to your message.

Forwarding between the client and the designer. Only the team can forward.

1. Under the message, click **Forward to designer** (on a designer's message: **Forward to client**).
2. Read the note:
    - to the designer: "The designer gets the text and pictures as 'Forwarded from the client'. Check it names nobody.";
    - to the client: "The client gets it from the team, never from the designer by name."

3. Click **Forward to designer** (or **Forward to client**) to send it, or **Cancel**. Files are cleaned again on the way. File types the destination cannot take are left out, and the message says how many.

> **Before you forward to a designer**
>
> Read the client's message first. If it contains their company name, an address or a phone number, do not forward it; retype the instruction instead. Anonymity is the product's promise.

Files on an order

File	Who adds it	When the client gets it
Reference photos, certificate pictures (in the brief)	Client (or the team, on-behalf)	Always (their own)
Screenshots of the request (on-behalf orders)	The team	Always; designers never
Rhino 3DM, STL	Designer, in the job's upload slots	From approval
Render views (one image with four views), Technical sheet	Designer	From **Ready to preview**
QC certificate, Weight sheet (PDF)	Made by the platform after QC	After QC passes
Summary sheet (PDF)	Made by the platform	From approval
Files sent in a conversation	Anyone in that conversation	In their own conversation only

Cleaning and names.

- Every upload is cleaned before it is stored. Author, studio and camera details are removed from 3DM, STL and image files, and Rhino blocks are exploded into plain geometry.
- Formats that cannot be cleaned are refused.
- Delivered files are named by the system (`ORDER_SLOT_vN`), fingerprinted, and archived read-only.

The team's Files panel on an order: **Upload a file** (PNG, JPEG or STEP), choose what it is, **Upload**. Each file shows its version (**v1**, **v2**…), **Download**, and **Held** where the client cannot have it yet.

Who sees what

Item	Client	Designer	Pod lead	Admin
The order's price, payments and refunds	Own orders	Never	Never	All
Designer pay on a job	Never	Own jobs only	Jobs in their pod	All
Pod pay on a job	Never	Never	Jobs in their pod	All
A designer's pay rate (₹ a minute)	Never	Never	Their pod's designers, read-only	All; can change
Client identity (business, name, email, phone)	Own	Never; sees a job code only	Client code; contact details on orders the team placed	All (Create order search)

Item	Client	Designer	Pod lead	Admin
Designer identity	Never; sees "Your team"	Own	Their pod's designers, by name	All
Brief, reference pictures and pins	Own orders	Assigned jobs	Pod orders	All
Client's master instructions	Own (Account)	Assigned jobs	Pod orders	All; can edit for a client
Screenshots of an emailed or WhatsApp request	Own orders	Never	Pod orders	All
Client conversation (Client tab)	Own orders, as "Your team"	**Never**	Pod orders	All
Designer conversation (Designer tab)	**Never**	Own jobs	Pod orders	All
Render views and technical sheet	Once QC passes (**Ready to preview** onwards)	Own jobs	Pod orders	All
3DM and STL files	From **approval** on; shown as **Locked** before	Own jobs	Pod orders	All
QC certificate and weight sheet	After QC passes	No	Pod orders	All
Summary sheet (PDF)	After approval	No	Pod orders	All
3D preview link	Creates and shares it	No	No	No
Designer bank details and identity documents	Never	Last 4 digits of their own account	Never	All; every full view and document open is logged

The client's emails carry no designer, pod lead or staff names.

Notifications and email

The platform tells people about events in three ways. They are separate, and only one of them proves a message reached an inbox.

Channel	Where it appears	Who gets it	Depends on
In-app notification	The bell (top of the sidebar; top bar on a phone), the unread count on **Messages**, and a pop-up "toast" with **Open** while the portal is open	Clients, designers, pod leads and admins, as listed below	Nothing: always written
Phone or desktop push	The device's own notification centre	Anyone who turned on **Notifications** under **Account → On this device** on that device	Push keys configured on the server; the 5-minute dispatch job running. Text never names people or amounts
Email	The person's inbox	Clients (order emails), designer applicants, website enquirers	`EMAIL_DELIVERY=live` on the server. Until then **every** email goes to the test inbox instead

> **A screen saying "sent" is not proof of delivery**
>
> An in-app toast or a status change confirms the action was recorded. An email is queued, then sent by the dispatcher straight after the action and by a sweep every 5 minutes, retrying up to 8 times. In **test mode** no client receives anything. Check **Admin → Settings → Email previews** (`/admin/emails`): the banner says "Test mode…" or "Live…".

In-app notifications: what triggers them

Event	Who is notified	Text they see
Client writes in the client conversation	The order's **pod lead**	"New message from the client."
Team writes in the client conversation	The **client**	"New message from the team."
Designer writes in the designer conversation	The order's **pod lead**	"New message from the designer."
Team writes in the designer conversation	The **designer**	"New message from the team."
Order quoted	Client	"Your order has been quoted."
Order paid **and** confirmed (clock starts)	Client; pod lead	"Your order is confirmed and paid — the first-look clock has started." / "An order in your pod is confirmed and paid — the clock is running."
Designer assigned	Designer	"You have been assigned to an order."
Job moved to another designer	Old designer; new designer (when it was waiting on changes)	"A job was moved to another designer" / "A job waiting on changes was moved to you"
Job taken back	Designer; every admin	"A job was taken back from you" / "A job was taken back from its designer and is waiting for a designer again"

Event	Who is notified	Text they see
Designer sends to QC	Pod lead; client	"A job in your pod is ready for QC." / "Work has been submitted on your order."
Due in 60 minutes / overdue to QC	Designer (both); pod lead (overdue)	"Job … is due to QC within the hour" / "Job … is past its due time to QC" / "Job … is overdue to QC"
Pod lead passes QC	Client	"Your order is ready to preview."
Client asks for changes	Designer; pod lead	"Changes requested (round n)…" / "The client asked for changes (round n)."
Client approves	Designer; pod lead	"The client approved this job." / "The client approved an order in your pod."
Order delivered	Client	"Your order has been delivered."
First-look deadline passed	Pod lead	"The first-look deadline on an order in your pod has passed."
Late credit issued	Client	"We missed the first-look deadline on your order — a credit has been issued."
Client raises a problem (dispute)	Designer	"A dispute was raised on your order."
Dispute resolved	Client; designer	"A dispute on your order was resolved."
Pod lead escalates a job	Every admin	"A pod lead escalated a job"
Admin resolves an escalation	The pod lead who raised it	"An admin resolved your escalation"
Client opens a spec claim	Pod lead	"A client opened a spec claim. Re-measure the archived file."
Spec claim decided	Client (and the pod lead, for the free fix when upheld)	Result of the claim
Client orders a change after approval	Pod lead	"A client ordered a change to an approved design. It needs a quote."
Team places an order for a client, with the email box ticked	Client	"The team placed an order for you."
Payout batch marked paid	Each payee	"Your pay of ₹… for this job was sent."
Order refunded	Client	"Your order has been refunded."

> **Admins are not notified of new orders or client messages**
>
> New orders appear on the **Queue**; nobody gets a notification for them. Client messages notify the order's **pod lead** only. An order has no pod until it is paid or confirmed, so **a message a client writes before then notifies nobody**. Check **Messages → Needs reply** every day.

Emails

Client emails are sent by the database event, never by a page, and each can be sent only once per event.

Event	Email	Client can turn it off
Client creates their own account	Welcome	No

Event	Email	Client can turn it off
Portal order sent for a price	Order received	No
Order quoted (each new price)	Quote ready	No
Quote unpaid for 24 hours	Quote reminder	Yes (Reminders)
Payment received	Payment received	No
Paid and confirmed (clock starts)	Order confirmed, with the due time in US Eastern time	No
First look ready / revised design ready	First look ready / Revised design ready	No
Changes requested	Revision received	No
Design waiting 48 hours	Preview reminder	Yes (Reminders)
Approved / delivered	Design approved / Files delivered	No
72 hours after delivery	Feedback request	Yes (Reminders)
Problem raised, refunded, cancelled (not a draft), first look missed, late credit decided	Matching email	No
Team writes in the client conversation	New message (at most one per order every 30 minutes)	Yes (Messages from your team)
Team places an order for the client, with the email box ticked	Order placed for you	—
Designer application received / accepted / rejected	Matching email to the applicant	—
Website contact form	Acknowledgement to the sender	—

Not sent by email at all: anything to designers about jobs (assignment, revisions, QC), anything to pod leads, and anything to admins. These are in-app and push only. There is no invoice email; the platform has no invoices yet.

Check whether emails reach clients

Open: Settings → Email previews (`/admin/emails`).

- **The banner** shows the mode:
  - "Live: emails go to their real recipients."
  - Or: "Test mode: every email goes to *test inbox*, with the real recipient in the subject. Clients receive nothing until EMAIL_DELIVERY=live."
- **Every template** with sample data, marked **Always sent** or **Can turn off**.
- **Send all N to *test inbox***: sends every template to the test inbox, so you can check how they look in Gmail, Outlook and Apple Mail.

> **Going live is a deployment setting, not a button**
>
> Switching email to live is done by the owner in the hosting settings (`EMAIL_DELIVERY=live` , then redeploy). See `docs/EMAIL.md` . Emails queued in test mode are not re-sent.

Money

Prices, categories and pay

Client prices are in US dollars. The website shows one price, "from $35 a design". The bands below are the internal defaults the quote form uses when **Price $** is left empty.

Band	Categories	Typical pieces	Price
Standard	A–C	Bands, solitaires, simple pendants and earrings	$35
Complex	D–F	Halo, pavé, multi-part, bracelets	$85
Sculpted / figurative	G–L	Signets with figures, sculpted, large multi-part	From $120, quoted; deadline in hours set with the price

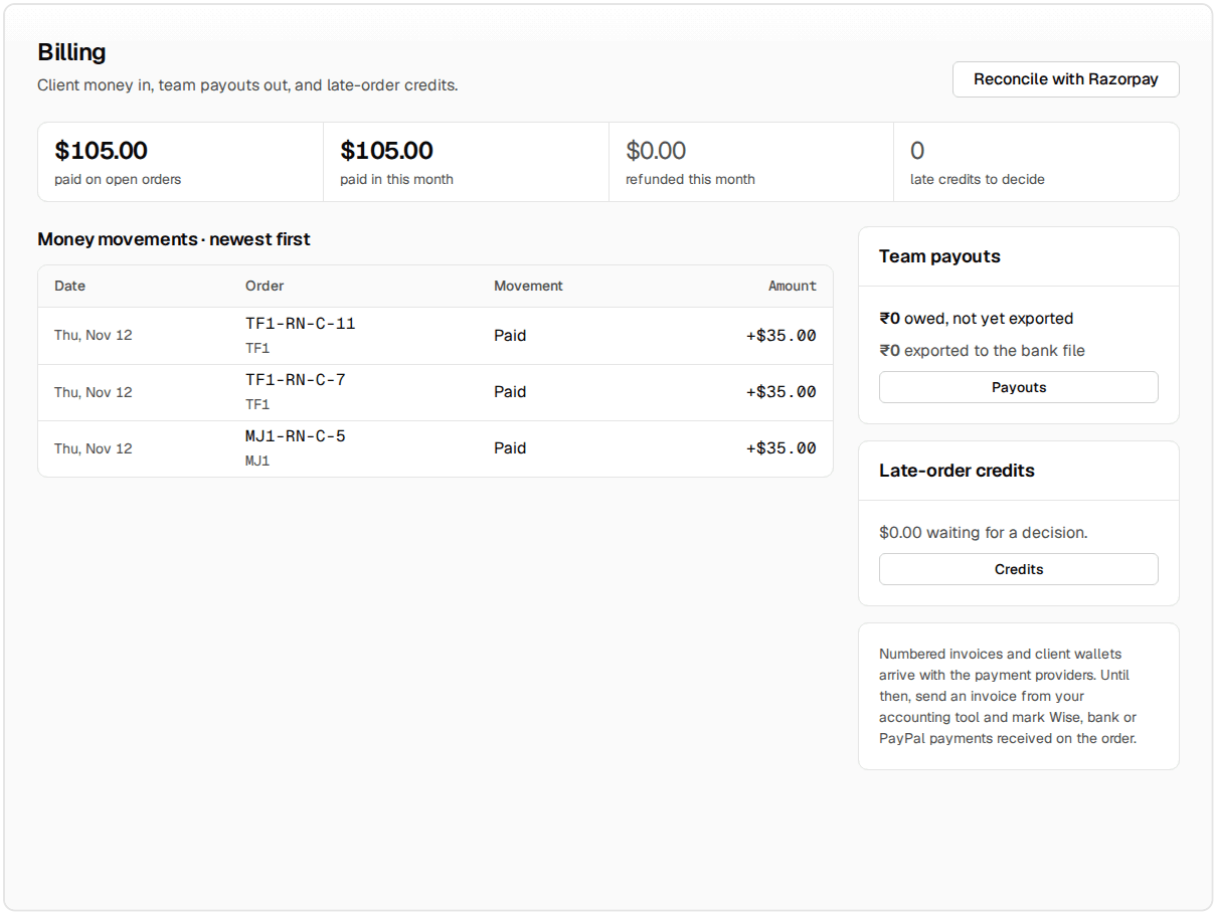
Team pay is in Indian rupees. It is set from the **category's minutes**, never from the price, so the price cannot be worked back from anyone's pay.

	Rule	Default	Changed on
Designer pay	Category minutes × the designer's rate	₹8 a minute (A ₹120, C ₹360, D ₹480, L ₹3,840)	**Settings** → **Money** → **Designer pay**; one designer's own rate on their page
Pod pay (to the pod lead who ran QC)	A share of the designer's pay on the job, with a minimum	50%, at least ₹300	**Settings** → **Money** → **Pod pay**, **Least pod pay**
Payout warning	Flags a quote when designer + pod pay exceed this share of the price	40%	**Settings** → **Money** → **Payout warning**
Exchange rate	Fixed rate used for that share	₹84 per $1	**Settings** → **Money** → **Exchange rate**

Pay is set at quote with the standard rate. It is set again at the assigned designer's rate when the job is assigned or moved. A rate or setting change reaches jobs assigned **after** it. QC send-backs are not paid extra. A change the client orders after approval is a new job at its own category.

Billing

Who: Admin or Finance. **Open:** sidebar → **Billing** (`/admin/billing`).



Billing: money in, payouts owed, credits

Figures across the top:

Figure	Counts
paid on open orders	Card payments and recorded transfers still held on orders not yet released or refunded (US dollars)
paid in this month	Payments recorded since the 1st of this calendar month (UTC)
refunded this month	Refunds recorded since the 1st of this calendar month
late credits to decide	Pending first-look credits

The rest of the page:

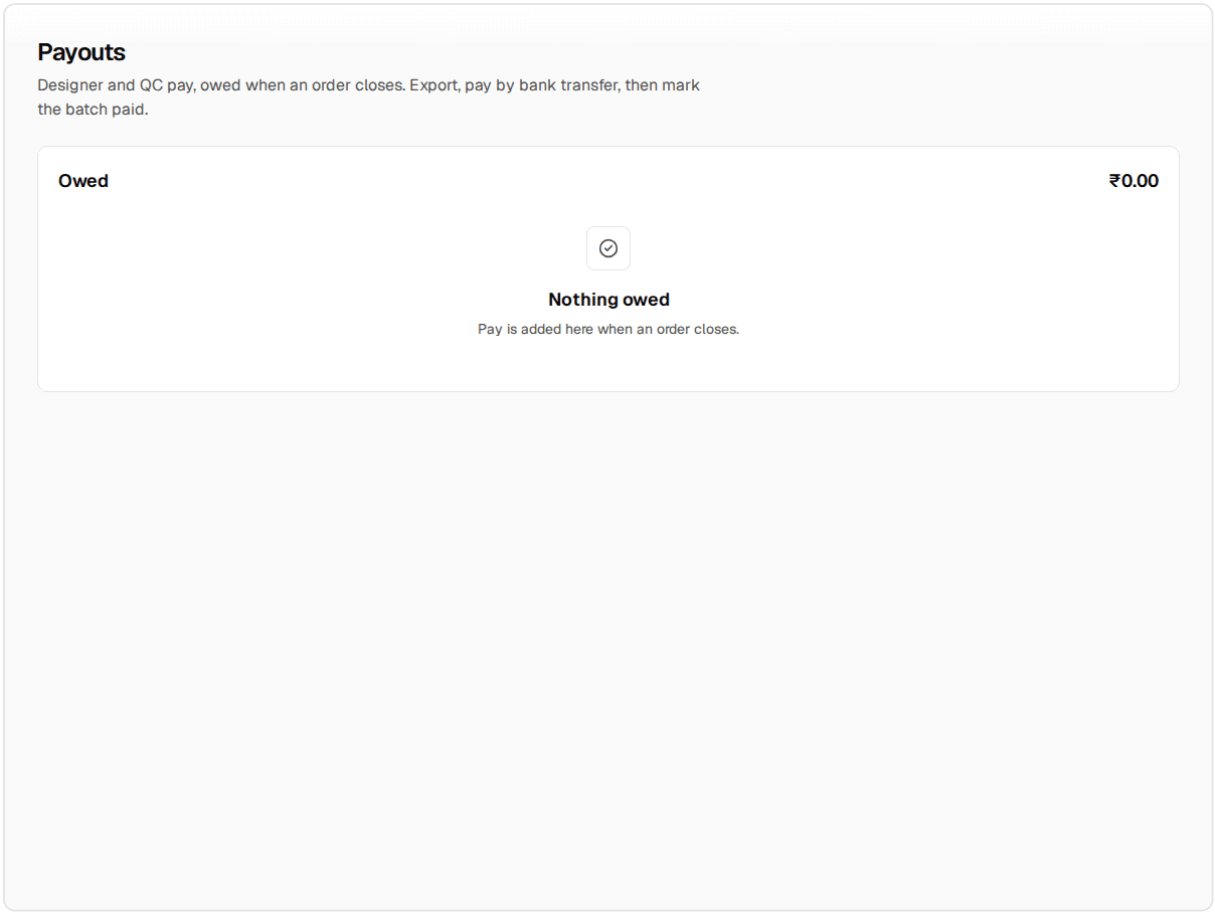
- **Money movements · newest first.** Up to 200 rows: **Date**, **Order** (with the client code), **Movement** (**Paid**, **Released**, **Refunded**, **Processor fee**, **Chargeback**, **Reversal**) and **Amount** with + or −. Click a row to open the order.
- **Team payouts.** Rupees owed and not yet exported, rupees exported to the bank file, and a link to **Payouts**.
- **Late-order credits.** How much is waiting for a decision, and a link to **Credits**.
- **Reconcile with Razorpay** (top right) opens the Razorpay dashboard in a new tab.

> **No invoices or wallets yet**
>
> The platform has no numbered invoices and no client wallet top-ups. Send an invoice from your accounting tool. Record Wise, bank and PayPal payments on the order with **Mark paid**. The client's **Wallet** shows their credit and payments only.

Pay designers and pod leads

Who: Finance or Admin. **Open: Billing** → **Payouts** (`/admin/payouts`).

Pay becomes **owed** when an order is **Closed**: one row for the designer and one for the pod lead who ran QC.



Payouts: owed rows, then batches

1. **Owed** lists each row: the payee, the order, the amount, and their bank state (**bank verified**, **bank not yet verified**, **bank rejected**).
2. Click **Export N as a batch (₹total)**. "Rows without usable bank details stay owed."
3. The batch appears below with its reference and "exported …, not yet marked paid". Click **Download CSV**.
4. Pay each line by bank transfer from the CSV.
5. Back on **Payouts**, click **Mark batch paid**.

> **Before you press Mark batch paid**
>
> Every payee in the batch is notified "Your pay of ₹… for this job was sent." It shows under their **Earnings** as paid. Press it only after the transfers have gone out. A batch cannot be un-marked.

Bank details:

- Designers enter their own under **Account** → **Payout details**, or an admin records them on the designer's page.
- Pod leads enter theirs from **Earnings** → **Add bank details**.
- A payee with no bank details, or rejected ones, stays owed until fixed.

> **Release payout (escrow) is a separate, older step**
>
> Closed orders also show **Ready for payout**, with **Release** on the Queue and **Release payout** on the order (Finance as primary role only). Releasing escrow records the money leaving escrow. It needs a verified payout account for both payees. It is not needed to pay people through **Payouts**.

Exports and reports

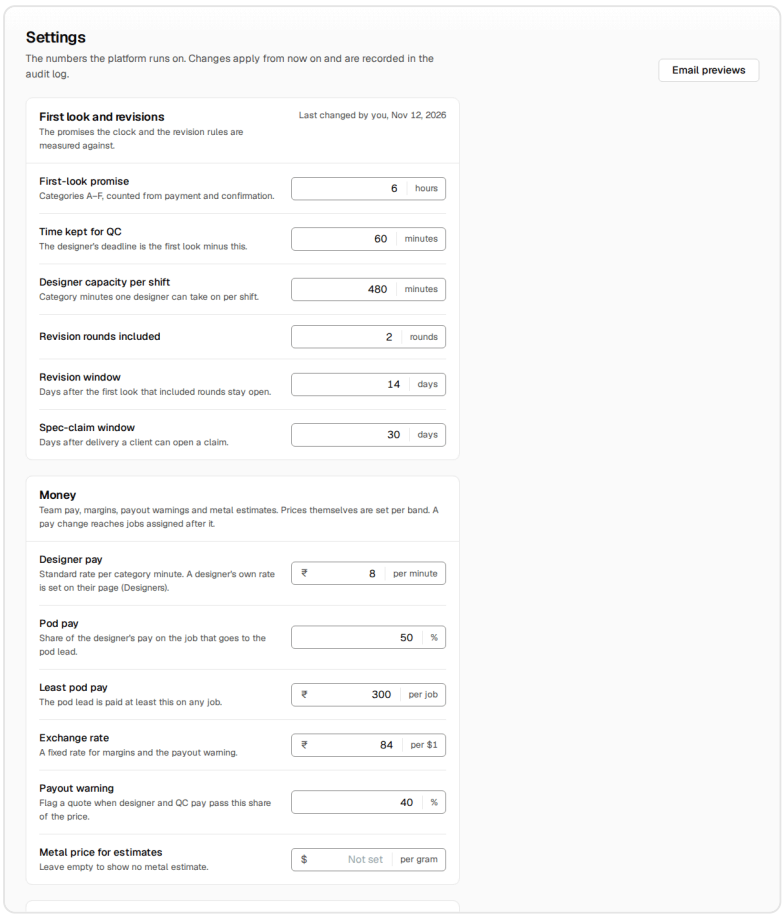
What	Where	Format
Every order	**All orders** → **Export CSV**	CSV
A payout batch	**Payouts** → the batch → **Download CSV**	CSV
A pod's performance (designers' output, working time, turnaround, quality)	**Performance** (pod lead view, also reached from an escalation) → download buttons	Excel, CSV, PDF
Public numbers and client sources	**Clients** (on screen)	—
An order's certificate, weight sheet, summary sheet	The order's **Order** card	PDF

Settings, switches and audit history

Settings

Open: sidebar → **Settings** (`/admin/settings`). Only a full Admin can change values; other staff see "Read-only. An admin (Sales + Ops + Finance) can change these."

"The numbers the platform runs on. Changes apply from now on and are recorded in the audit log." Each section shows **Last changed by** a person and a time.



Settings

Section	Setting	Unit	Default	Effect
First look and revisions	**First-look promise**	hours	6	The standard (A–F) first-look deadline, counted from payment and confirmation
	Time kept for QC	minutes	60	The designer's deadline is the first look minus this
	Designer capacity per shift	minutes	480	Category minutes one designer may hold at once before a warning
	Revision rounds included	rounds	2	Client change rounds included in the price
	Revision window	days	14	Days after the first look that included rounds stay open

Section	Setting	Unit	Default	Effect
	Spec-claim window	days	30	Days after delivery a client can open a claim
Money	**Designer pay**	₹ per minute	8.00	The standard rate
	Pod pay	%	50	Share of the designer's pay that goes to the pod lead
	Least pod pay	₹ per job	300	Minimum pod pay on any job
	Exchange rate	₹ per $1	84.00	Used for margins and the payout warning
	Payout warning	%	40	Flag a quote when team pay passes this share of the price
	Metal price for estimates	$ per gram	empty	Leave empty to show no metal estimate
Metal densities	**10K gold**, **14K gold**, **18K gold**, **Platinum 950**, **Sterling silver 925**	g/cm³	11.6, 13.1, 15.6, 21.4, 10.4	Turn a model's volume into weights on the weight sheet
Spec sheet defaults	**Minimum wall**, **Minimum prong**	mm	0.80, 0.80	Printed on every spec sheet unless the order says otherwise

To change values:

1. Edit one or more fields. A bar appears at the bottom: "N changes not saved", listing each change as before → after.
2. Click **Save changes**, or **Discard**. Invalid values are highlighted: "Fix the highlighted values first".
3. A message confirms it: "Change saved" or "N changes saved". A refused value says why.

> **Before you save a money or density change**
>
> Money changes apply to jobs assigned **after** the save. Density changes alter weight sheets made from then on. Every change is logged with your name.

Developer · raw keys and stored values (folded at the bottom) lists every stored key, its raw value and description. It is for technical support.

Feature switches

On **Settings** → **Features**. "A switch applies at once. The database honours it too, not just this screen."

Switch	Off (current default)	On
Block assignment over shift capacity	Over-capacity assignments only warn	Refused, except for an admin who gives a reason
Automatic late-order credit	An admin decides each missed first look	Not available to rely on yet: keep off
Payouts through Razorpay	Export the batch and pay by bank transfer	Not connected yet: keep off
Wallet, credit packs and plans	Off	Not built for clients yet: keep off

Switch	Off (current default)	On
One-page render brief	(on by default) render orders use a one-page brief	—
Public results page	`/results` hidden	Turn on after 30 days of real data
Rush delivery	Off	Not defined yet: keep off
Dental	Off	A separate brand, not part of this platform

> **Switches act immediately**
>
> There is no confirmation and no Save button: a switch changes behaviour for everyone at once. Note what you changed and why.

Audit history: who did what

Every decision is written to the audit history with the person who made it. That covers quotes, payments, assignments, moves, QC marks and decisions, credits, payouts, role and status changes, setting changes, bank-detail views and document opens.

Where to see it on screen:

- **An order's Timeline:** every status change and event on that order.
- **A designer's page in Performance** (pod lead view): **Activity**, the last 200 events.
- **Settings: Last changed by** per section.

> **No audit browser**
>
> There is no screen that lists the whole audit history, for example "every role change last month". Ask technical support to query it, and give the person, the period and the kind of event.

How the accounts work together

The whole flow, seen from every seat. Use it to train a new admin, or to find where a stuck order went wrong.

This walkthrough follows one fictional order through every account. The names are invented: the client **Northline Jewelers** (client code `NJ1`), the piece **"Aurora halo ring"**, a pod called **Rhino pod**, and two designers, **DSG-0007** (new) and **DSG-0003**. The order includes one blocked handoff, one QC send-back and one client revision round.

> **How to read each step**
>
> **Who** acts, **the control** they use, **what changes** on their screen, **who receives it** and what they see, and **how the admin checks** it.

Step 1 · The client sends the brief

- **Who:** the Northline buyer (Client).
- **Control: New order** → **CAD design** → fill **The piece**, **Stones** and **Size & metal** → **Review** → **Send for a price**.
- **Changes:** the page "Sent for a price" opens. On the order, the status sentence reads "We're pricing your brief".
- **Received by:** nobody gets a notification. The client receives the "Order received" email.
- **Admin checks: Queue**. The **Awaiting quote** counter goes up by one, and the order appears under **Needs a move** with **Price it**.

Step 2 · The team prices it

- **Who:** an Admin (or a Sales member).
- **Control: Queue** → **Price it** (opens the order) → **Next step** card → **Category** `C`, **Price $ (optional)** left empty (the band price, $35) → **Set quote**.
- **Changes:** the status pill becomes **Quoted**, and the order card shows **Price**, **Designer pay** and **Pod pay**.
- **Received by:** the client gets an in-app notification "Your order has been quoted." and the "Quote ready" email. Their order shows "Your price is ready" with **Pay & start**.
- **Admin checks:** the Queue counter **Awaiting payment**.

Step 3 · The client pays

- **Who:** the client, by card or UPI. **Or**, for a Wise transfer, an Admin or Finance member.
- **Control (card): Pay & start** → the pay button → Razorpay checkout. **Control (transfer):** the order → **Next step** → **Paid by** `Wise transfer`, **Reference** (the transfer reference) → **Mark paid**.
- **Changes:** the status becomes **Paid**. With only one pod led, the order joins **Rhino pod** automatically.
- **Received by:** the client gets the "Payment received" email and sees "Paid · we're checking your brief".
- **Admin checks:** the Queue row now reads "Paid · confirm the order to start the clock", with **Confirm**.

Step 4 · The admin confirms the brief

- **Who:** an Admin (a pod lead may also confirm).

- **Control:** the order → **Next step** → **Confirm order**.
- **Changes:** the first-look clock starts (6 hours for category C). The Queue row reads "Paid and confirmed · the pod lead assigns a designer".
- **Received by:** the client is notified "Your order is confirmed and paid — the first-look clock has started." and gets the "Order confirmed" email with the due time. The pod lead is notified "An order in your pod is confirmed and paid — the clock is running."
- **Admin checks:** the **First look** column on the Queue shows the time left.

Step 5 · Blocked handoff: the new designer cannot be chosen

- **Who:** the Rhino pod lead.
- **Control: QC queue** → **Team board** → the order under **Unassigned** → **Assign to…**.
- **What they see:** DSG-0007 is listed but greyed out, marked "· not signed" ("(not signed up)" on the order page). The admin added DSG-0007 to the pod yesterday, but DSG-0007 has not yet signed the designer agreement.
- **Resolution:** the pod lead writes to an admin, or assigns DSG-0003 instead. The admin opens **Designers** → DSG-0007, sees **Waiting to sign in**, and sends DSG-0007 the sign-in instructions shown on that page. Once DSG-0007 signs in and presses **I have read and agree — sign**, the status becomes **Active** and the name is selectable.
- **Admin checks: Designers**. The status pill reads **Active**, and the **Pods** page no longer says "Not signed".

Step 6 · The pod lead assigns

- **Who:** the pod lead.
- **Control: Assign to…** → DSG-0007 · `0/480` → **Assign**.
- **Changes:** the job moves into DSG-0007's column on the team board. The order says "Assigned to DSG-0007 · not started yet". Designer pay is set at DSG-0007's rate.
- **Received by:** DSG-0007 is notified "You have been assigned to an order." The job appears on their **Home** under **Needs you** as "New job".
- **Admin checks:** the Queue counter **With designer**. On the order, **Designer** shows DSG-0007.

Step 7 · The designer builds version 1 and sends it to QC

- **Who:** DSG-0007.
- **Control: Open jobs** → the job → **Start work**. Upload the four files (Rhino 3DM, STL, Render views, Technical sheet). Save the **Model volume**. Fill **Gold weight and diamonds** → **Save weights**. Mark every **Designer check** line **Pass**. Then **Final review and send to QC** → **Send to QC**.
- **Changes:** the job reads "With your pod lead for QC".
- **Received by:** the pod lead is notified "A job in your pod is ready for QC." The client is notified "Work has been submitted on your order." and sees "We're checking the design".
- **Admin checks:** the Queue counter **In QC**.

Step 8 · QC sends it back once

- **Who:** the pod lead.
- **Control: QC queue** → **Awaiting QC** → **Start review**. Under **All measurements**, type a finding and a remark, then **Fail**. Then **Send back · revision needed**.

- **Changes:** the status becomes **Revision requested**. QC send-backs do not use up the client's revision rounds.
- **Received by:** DSG-0007 sees the failed line under **Pod lead notes** on the job, then presses **Start work** again and sends version 2.
- **Admin checks:** the order **Timeline** shows the send-back. The Queue counter is back to **With designer**.

Step 9 · QC passes it to the client

- **Who:** the pod lead.
- **Control:** mark all five **QC manager** lines **Pass** → fill **Measured specification** → **Record measurements** → **Approve · pass to client**.
- **Changes:** the status becomes **Ready to preview**. The first look is recorded and the clock stops: on time.
- **Received by:** the client is notified "Your order is ready to preview." and gets the "First look ready" email.
- **Admin checks:** the Queue counter **With client**. The **First look** column says **Done**.

Step 10 · The client asks for one change

- **Who:** the client.
- **Control: Review** → under **Ask for changes**, describe the change (sizes in mm, which view, which part) → **Send changes**.
- **Changes:** the client's page shows "1 of 2 rounds used" and "Your changes are being made".
- **Received by:** DSG-0007 and the pod lead are notified "Changes requested (round 1)…". The job comes back as "Changes requested" with **Changes the client asked for**.
- **Admin checks:** the order's **Revisions** section lists round 1. DSG-0007 sends version 3, and QC passes it as in steps 7–9.

Step 11 · The client approves

- **Who:** the client.
- **Control: Review** → **Approve this design**.
- **Changes:** the status becomes **Approved**. The STL, 3DM and summary sheet unlock in the client's **Files**.
- **Received by:** DSG-0007 and the pod lead are notified "The client approved…". The client gets the "Design approved" email.
- **Admin checks:** the Queue row reads "Client approved · deliver the files" with **Deliver**.

Step 12 · The team delivers and closes

- **Who:** an Admin (or an Ops member).
- **Control:** the order → **Next step** → **Delivered**. Later, **Next step** → **Closed**.
- **Changes:** the order goes from **Delivered** to **Closed**. Closing creates the designer's and the pod lead's pay as **Owed**.
- **Received by:** the client gets "Your order has been delivered." and the "Files delivered" email.
- **Admin checks:** the Queue counter **Ready for payout**. **Payouts** lists two owed rows for this order.

Step 13 · The team is paid

- **Who:** an Admin (or a Finance member).

- **Control: Billing** → **Payouts** → **Export … as a batch** → **Download CSV**. Pay by bank transfer from the CSV, then **Mark batch paid**.
- **Received by:** DSG-0007 and the pod lead are notified "Your pay of ₹… for this job was sent." The amount shows under their **Earnings**.
- **Admin checks:** the batch no longer says "not yet marked paid".

Reference

Permissions matrix

The database enforces every row of this table. **Own** means the client's own orders. **Assigned** means jobs assigned to that designer. **Pod** means orders and designers in the pod lead's own pod. **All** means everything. A dash means never.

Item and action	Client	Designer	Pod lead	Admin
Orders: view	Own	Assigned (no price, no client identity)	Pod (no price)	All
Create an order	Own (portal)	—	For a client, in their pod	For any client
Write or edit the brief	Own, until priced	—	On-behalf orders in the pod	On-behalf orders
Set the quote	—	—	—	All (Sales role)
Record a transfer (**Mark paid**)	—	—	—	All (Finance role)
Choose or move the pod	—	—	—	All
Confirm order	—	—	Pod	All
Assign a designer	—	—	Pod	All (exception; Ops role)
Move or take back a job	—	—	Pod	All
Escalate a job	—	—	Pod	— (admins resolve)
Start, pause, send to QC	—	Assigned	—	—
QC pass or send back	—	—	Pod	—
Approve, ask for changes, raise a problem	Own	—	—	—
Deliver, close	—	—	—	All (Ops role)
Refund, resolve a dispute by refund	—	—	—	All (Finance as primary role)
Resolve a dispute by rework	—	—	—	All (Ops as primary role)
Cancel or delete	Own, before payment	—	—	— (nothing is deleted)
Files: upload deliverables	—	Assigned	—	—
Download deliverables	Own (renders from preview; 3DM and STL from approval)	Assigned	Pod	All
Certificate, weight sheet	Own, after QC	—	Pod	All

Item and action	Client	Designer	Pod lead	Admin
Summary sheet	Own, after approval	—	Pod	All
Messages: client conversation	Own	—	Pod	All
designer conversation	—	Assigned	Pod	All
Forward between the two	—	—	Pod	All
People: add designers; bank details; documents	—	Own bank details	—	All
Place designers in pods; create pods; set pod leads	—	—	—	All
Set a designer's own rate	—	—	View, pod	All
Change roles; suspend; reinstate	—	—	—	All (Ops role)
Applications, leads	—	—	—	All (Sales or Ops role)
Account managers; client list	—	—	—	All
Money: Billing	—	—	—	All (Finance role)
Payouts: export, mark paid	—	—	—	All (Finance role)
Late credits: decide	—	—	—	All
Spec claims: decide	—	—	Pod	All
Own earnings	—	Own	Own	—
System: change Settings and switches	—	—	—	All (full Admin only)
Share or remove pod materials	—	View, own pod	Pod	All
Performance	—	—	Pod	Opens from escalations

Staff with one role only have the single slice named in brackets. The table of staff roles shows each one.

Status and handoff table

Every order carries one **status**. The team sees it as a status pill (for example **Paid**) and, on the Queue, as a stage (for example **Ready to assign**). The client sees a plain sentence instead (for example "Paid · we're checking your brief"). The table lists them in the order a normal job moves through them.

Status pill	Queue stage	What it means	Who acts next, and the control that moves it on	What the client sees	What the designer sees
Draft	(not on the Queue)	The client is still writing the brief	Client: **Send for a price** on the Review step	"Finish your brief" · **Continue**	Nothing
Submitted	Awaiting quote	Brief sent; no price yet	Sales or Admin: **Set quote** on the order	"We're pricing your brief"	Nothing

Status pill	Queue stage	What it means	Who acts next, and the control that moves it on	What the client sees	What the designer sees
Quoted	Awaiting payment	Price set and shown to the client	Client: **Pay & start**. Or Finance/Admin: **Mark paid** for a transfer	"Your price is ready" · **Pay & start**	Nothing
Paid	Ready to assign	Money received. Still needs a pod, a confirmation and a designer	Admin: choose the pod (if asked) and **Confirm order**. Pod lead: **Assign**	"Paid · we're checking your brief", then after confirmation "Confirmed · your designer starts shortly"	Nothing
Assigned	With designer	A designer has the job but has not started	Designer: **Start work**	"Your designer is working on it"	The job under **Open jobs** ("New job")
In progress	With designer	The designer is working; their clock runs (it stops while paused)	Designer: **Send to QC** from the final review	"Your designer is working on it"	Their job, with the clock
Work submitted	In QC	Momentary: the platform moves it to QC review at once	— (automatic)	"We're checking the design"	"Submitted to QC"
In QC review	In QC	The pod lead checks the work	Pod lead: **Approve · pass to client** or **Send back · revision needed**	"We're checking the design"	"With your pod lead for QC"
Revision requested	With designer	Back with the designer: a QC send-back or the client's changes	Designer: **Start work**, then send to QC again	"Your changes are being made"	"Changes requested" with the notes
Ready to preview	With client	The first look (or a new version) is with the client	Client: **Approve this design**, **Send changes**, or **Raise a problem**	"Your design is ready" / "A new version is ready" · **Review**	Nothing new
Approved	Ready to deliver	Client approved; their files unlock at once	Ops or Admin: **Delivered**	"Files ready" · **Download**	Notification "The client approved this job."
Delivered	Delivered	Delivered to the client	Ops or Admin: **Closed** (the client's screen has no close button)	"Files ready"	Nothing new
Closed	Ready for payout	Finished. Designer pay and pod pay become **owed**	Finance/Admin: pay through **Payouts**	"Files ready"	Pay appears under **Earnings**
Payout released	(done)	Escrow released to the payout records	—	"Files ready"	—
Disputed	Dispute	The client raised a problem; the order is frozen	Ops: **Send back for rework**, or Finance: **Refund the client…**	"We're looking into a problem" · **Message**	Notification "A dispute was raised on your order."
Refunded	(done)	Money returned to the client	—	"Refunded"	—
Cancelled	(done)	Cancelled before payment, or a price declined	—	"Cancelled"	—

The first-look clock. For standard pieces (categories A–F) the promise is a first look within **6 hours**. The clock starts when the order is both **paid** and **confirmed**, whichever happens last. It stops when the pod lead passes the work to the client. Complex pieces (G–L) have the deadline set with the price. The designer's own deadline ("Due to QC") is the first-look deadline minus the time kept for QC (60 minutes by default).

Troubleshooting by symptom

Work through the checks in order. Stop at the first one that explains it.

"The designer is visible but cannot be assigned"

The name shows greyed out, marked "· not signed" on the Team board or "(not signed up)" on the order page.

1. **Designers** → the designer. Is the status **Waiting to sign in** or **Pending**? They have not signed the current agreement. Send them the sign-in line from their page and ask them to sign. If they say they signed, ask whether they were asked to sign a *new* version.
2. **Access** → the designer. Is the status **Suspended**? Reinstate them if that is intended.
3. **Access** → is their role still **Designer**?
4. Is the order in the same pod as the designer? Compare the order's **Pod** with the designer's **Pod**.
5. Is the order **Paid** with no designer? An order that already has a designer is moved, not assigned (how). The error says "this job is already with a designer…".
6. Is the error "Over capacity…"? Either **Block assignment over shift capacity** is on (an admin can override with a reason), or choose a designer with room.
7. Still stuck: technical support, with the order reference and the designer's reference.

"The pod lead cannot see a designer at all"

1. **Designers** → the designer → **Pod**. "Not in a pod"? Place them in the pod.
2. **Pods** → is the pod led by this pod lead?
3. Was the designer added as a designer? **Access** → role **Designer**.

"An order is missing from my Queue"

1. The Queue lists only orders where **the team** moves next. An order with the designer, in QC or with the client is not listed; only the counter includes it. Use **All orders** or **Search** (`Ctrl` + `K`) with the reference.
2. Is a stage filter on? Click **Clear filter**.
3. Is it a **Draft**? Drafts are the client's private work until sent.
4. Is it **Cancelled** or **Refunded**? Look under **All orders** → **Closed**.

"A job is missing from the pod lead's queue or board"

1. Is the order in their pod? On the order, **Pod**. If it reads "Not chosen", choose the pod.
2. Is it paid? Orders join a pod at payment or confirmation.
3. On the board, an unassigned job without a category shows **Set a category first**.
4. The QC queue lists only **In QC review** jobs. Everything else is on **Team board** or **All orders**.

"A job is missing from the designer's Open jobs"

1. On the order, does **Designer** name them? If not, it was never assigned, or it was moved or taken back (see the **Timeline**).
2. **Access** → are they **Suspended**?
3. Once sent to QC, a job moves to the **Submitted to QC** tab of **Open jobs**.

"The client cannot see the file"

1. Check the order's status. Render views and the technical sheet unlock at **Ready to preview**. The 3DM, STL and summary sheet unlock at **Approved**. Before that they show **Locked** or are absent.
2. Is the client looking at the right order? Files are listed per order on **Files**.
3. Did the designer upload into the right slot? The team's **Files** panel shows each version.
4. A render-only order has no STL, 3DM, certificate or weight sheet.
5. A file sent in the **Designer** conversation is never visible to the client. Forward it (how).
6. Still missing: technical support, with the order reference and the file name.

"A notification did not arrive"

1. **Is it an event that notifies anyone?** Check the trigger table. Admins are not notified of new orders or client messages. Client messages notify only the pod lead, and only once the order has a pod.
2. **In-app.** Ask the person to open the bell. If the notification is there, the in-app part worked.
3. **Push.** Did they turn on **Notifications** under **Account → On this device**, on *that* device? On iPhone the app must first be added to the home screen. Push is sent by a job every 5 minutes.
4. **Email.** Open **Settings → Email previews**. In **Test mode**, nothing reaches clients. Did the client turn off that kind of email (**Account → Email**)? Only messages and reminders can be turned off. Did they check spam?
5. **Still nothing:** technical support. Give the order reference, the time, and the email template name; the email outbox records every attempt and its error.

"The client paid but the order still shows Quoted"

1. Wait a minute and reload. Card payments are confirmed by Razorpay to the platform, usually within seconds.
2. Look in the Razorpay dashboard (**Billing → Reconcile with Razorpay**). Is the payment there and captured?
3. If it is captured but the order is still **Quoted**, the confirmation did not reach the platform. Technical support can re-send it from Razorpay; doing so is safe and never double-counts.
4. For a transfer, check your bank or Wise, then Mark paid.

"A button I expect is not there"

Missing	Why	Fix
Set quote	Not Submitted; or you lack the Sales role	Check the status and your roles on **Account**
Mark paid	Not Quoted; or you lack the Finance role	Same
Confirm order	Already confirmed; or the order is past In progress	—
Assign (admin)	It is under **Other actions ›**; or the order already has a designer	Use **Move it to another designer**

Missing	Why	Fix
Refund client, **Release payout**, **Refund the client…**	Shown only to a primary Finance role	Primary-role buttons
Send back for rework	Shown only to a primary Ops role	Same
Approve · pass to client	Only the pod lead, on the QC review	Admins cannot QC
A whole page says "Not available to your role"	That screen needs a role you do not have (for example Designers, Pods and Settings changes need a full Admin)	Make someone a full Admin

"The designer cannot send to QC"

The **Final review** lists what is missing:

- every **Designer check** line must pass;
- all four files must be uploaded (Rhino 3DM, STL, Render views, Technical sheet);
- the **Model volume** must be saved;
- the **gold weight** must be saved.

The team can see progress on the order's **Order** card. One line gives the version, the designer and QC check counts, and the files uploaded.

"The clock did not start"

The clock starts only when the order is **both paid and confirmed**. The order's line says what it is waiting for: "The 6-hour clock starts once the order is paid and confirmed — waiting for …". Confirm or record the payment.

"A payout stays owed after export"

Rows without usable bank details are not exported. **Designers** → the payee → **Bank details** (or, for a pod lead, ask them to add theirs under **Earnings** → **Add bank details**). Then export again.

"Access shows references instead of emails"

The look-up of names at the sign-in service failed, or your role may not make it. The page says "Couldn't load emails — showing account references only". Reload. If it persists, technical support.

When to call technical support

- Granting or removing additional staff roles (making a full Admin).
- Anything needing the audit history beyond an order's timeline.
- Re-sending a payment confirmation from Razorpay.
- Email or push configuration (test mode, live mode, keys, the 5-minute job).
- Any error message that names the database ("refused", "permission denied") on an action this manual says you may do.

Give the **order reference** or **account reference** (or **Copy account ID** from Access), the time, and the exact message on screen.

Screen-by-screen reference

Screen	Path	How to open	Purpose	Main controls	Guide
Queue	`/admin`	Sidebar · home page	Orders where the team moves next	Stage counters, alerts, row actions, **Reconcile**, **Create order**	Queue
All orders	`/admin/orders`	Sidebar	Every order	Tabs, **Search orders**, **Every stage**, **Save this view**, **Export CSV**	All orders
Order (team)	`/orders/…`	Any order row	One order	**Next step**, **Other actions ›**, Brief, Conversations, Files, Timeline, Order card	Order page
Create order	`/admin/new-order`	Sidebar; Queue	Order for a client who emailed or used WhatsApp	Find the client, New client, The order, Screenshots, **Place order**	On behalf
Messages	`/messages`	Sidebar	Every conversation	Filters, search, tabs, forward, mark up	Messages
Billing	`/admin/billing`	Sidebar	Money in and out	Figures, movements, **Payouts**, **Credits**, **Reconcile with Razorpay**	Billing
Payouts	`/admin/payouts`	Billing	Pay the team	**Export … as a batch**, **Download CSV**, **Mark batch paid**	Payouts
Credits	`/admin/credits`	Queue alert; Billing	Late first-look credits	**Decision**, **Amount**, **Reason**, **Decide**	Credits
Clients	`/admin/clients`	Sidebar	Clients by code	**Recompute**, search, **Account manager**	Clients
Access	`/admin/access`	Sidebar	Accounts and roles	Tabs, search, **Role**, ⋯ (Copy account ID, Suspend…, Reinstate), **Pods**	Access
Pods	`/admin/access/pods`	Access → Pods	Pods, leads, members	**Create their pod**, **Change pod lead…**, **Add a designer…**, **Remove**, **Create pod**	Pods
Applications	`/admin/applications`	Sidebar	Designer applications	Tabs, **Accept**, **Reject**, **Reopen**	Applications
Leads	`/admin/leads`	Sidebar	Website contact messages	Tabs, **Mark handled**, **Reopen**	Leads
Designers	`/admin/designers`	Sidebar → More	Your designers	**Add designers**, each designer's page	Designers
Designer	`/admin/designers/…`	Designers	One designer	Sign-in, **Pod**, **Pay rate**, **Bank details**, **Documents**	Designers
Settings	`/admin/settings`	Sidebar	Numbers and switches	Fields, **Save changes**, **Discard**, **Features**, **Email previews**	Settings
Emails	`/admin/emails`	Settings → Email previews	Email mode and templates	**Send all … to …**	Email previews
Performance	`/pod/performance`	Queue escalation alert	Escalations and pod figures	**Resolve**, filters, downloads	Escalations
Account	`/account`	Your name → Account	Your identity and settings	Time zone, Notifications, Sign out	Account

`/admin/users` redirects to **Access**. `/dashboard` is an older summary page kept for links. `/account/kit` is the design team's component sample page; it is not used in operations.

Glossary

Term	Meaning
Account reference	A person's short code (ACC… for clients, DSG… for designers). Quote it to support.
Assignable	A designer who is Active, has signed the current agreement and is in the order's pod.
Band	The default price for a group of categories: $35, $85, from $120.
Brief	The client's description of the piece: what it is, stones, size, metal, notes, reference photos.
Category (A–L)	The job's size in minutes, from A (15 min) to L (480 min). It sets the band and the team's pay.
Change order	A change the client orders after approval: a new order, priced on its own.
Client code	The client's short code on every order reference, for example `NJ1`.
Escrow / held	Money the client paid that the platform records as held against the order until it is released or refunded.
First look	The first version the client sees, after QC. The 6-hour promise is measured to it.
Master instructions	A client's standing factory rules, shown on every one of their orders.
On-behalf order	An order the team placed for a client from an email, WhatsApp or phone request.
Order reference	The order's code, for example `MJ1-RN-C-12`: client, product, category, number.
Pod / pod lead	A team of designers and the lead who assigns and checks their work.
Primary role	The one role set on Access. Some buttons follow it.
QC	Quality control: the designer's 9-line check, then the pod lead's 5-line check.
Revision round	One set of client changes. Two are included within 14 days of the first look.
Spec claim / waiver	A client's claim that a delivered file broke its spec sheet. A waiver is a spec the client asked to relax, recorded on the certificate.
Toast	A short message that pops up at the edge of the screen and fades.